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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Monday, December 2, 2024

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3QIhrgigz4E
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:33:05] call to order the work session for the Board of Education this afternoon, Monday, December the 2nd. So what I would like to do is open with Dr. Coons providing some opening comments, please. Are we having a mic problem? Are we good? Okay, great. All right, Dr. Coons.

[00:33:32] Well, I just want to start with this season of gratitude for the department staff. We've had some really great things happen recently. Our department has partnered with VASS to provide school divisions with a team of people, including a superintendent, four days of AI framework planning with national experts. 72 school divisions have taken advantage of this opportunity.

[00:33:56] We have also partnered with Germanna Community College and other VCCS partners to provide 16 half-day PD sessions across all eight regions about teaching with AI for teachers and instructional coaches. We believe this is the only statewide effort in the country and really want to give a huge shout out to Dr. Myers and his team for partnering with VAS on that. In partnership with Virginia Works, the department was awarded a $6 million competitive grant with the U.S. Department of Labor to develop and expand registered teacher apprenticeship pathways and pre-apprenticeship

[00:34:33] opportunities for future teachers in Virginia. Our Office of Human Capital solicited grant proposals from ed prep teams and local school divisions. We received 14 submissions from EPPs, that's

39% of all EPPs, that have requested support for 625 teacher apprentices, and our goal was to support 170 teacher apprentices so we have a large body of interest with a request of over 11 and a half million dollars with a budget of two and a half million dollars so we're really excited to expand our pipeline work and excited for the interest across the commonwealth i'm going to give a huge

[00:35:11] shout out to dr gilstrap and dr raley for leading that work want to talk about our new vqb5 portal was launched in october with 3 121 site quality profiles for child care head start family child care and school-based preschools this provides parents with a one-stop shop for health safety and learning information that reflects insights from 28 000 classroom observations 98 of the sites meet expectations with 79 nation leading exemplars in all program types since the launch

[00:35:47] there have been 38 000 views of the portal and 850 data downloads of the state data since october in addition the early childhood team completed nine in-person deep dives in october and november throughout the ready regions which support over 400 leaders in education educators from child care family child care head start early childhood special education community colleges higher ed business training and technical assistance and then we had two schools i know we recognized several schools at our last board meeting, but we have Greendale Elementary School in Washington

[00:36:22] County and Belmont Elementary School in Prince William County as our ESEA Distinguished School winners that are recognized for exceptional student performance for two years. And then finally, the department received our official late liquidation request approval that allows us to extend our ESSER funds through March 31st, 2026. This will allow Virginia to continue our Grow Your Own, our chronic absenteeism dashboard, our Zern, our Ignite, and Lexia program for school divisions. Moreover, our team, our finance team, and our late liquidation ESSER team, I just want

[00:37:00] to give them a huge shout out. We have probably the best drawdown in the country with 0.02% of drawdown funds for ESSER left to be spent. That is amazing and unheard of. So we are almost completely spent on our ESSER III dollars. So just want to shout out the different work from everything from human capital to finance and the great work that our teams are doing at the department. Thank you, Dr. Koons. And now we will move to Dr. Myers. You are starting us off with

[00:37:34] presentation under item A. Okay. Dr. Myers, Dr. Armstrong, and M. Okay, come on up. I'm going to kick off the department team last month we had the opportunity to launch the performance and support framework hub and this hub is a one-stop shop for everything from what is other performance framework

[00:38:12] that the board voted to approve in august to what's the data behind that what are the supports and really we have partnered shoulder to shoulder with our school divisions on how to use data to have transparent data to have more data available for school leaders and for school division leaders to really understand where they are where they're going and what they need so i'm very proud of the work we have accomplished to create the performance support framework hub this is to wrap around all of the work the board has been doing for over two years and working towards with the framework that

[00:38:49] was approved in august and september so i'm very excited that we are going to move to that and work through the framework with our team. And I just kind of want to introduce that Dr. Armstrong oversees our accountability work at the agency. Dr. Myers oversees, undersees, or works around, spends a whole lot of time with numbers and data, and does all of the data work at the agency.

[00:39:14] And our deputy teaching of learning, M. Cooper, manages all of our support frameworks. So all three of our cabinet members are going to work today and talk about the performance and support framework hub thank you dr coons madam president and board members good afternoon as you can see on this slide the board's work began in the summer of 2022 prior to the arrival of many of us myself included to the agency and deep design work of the school performance support framework commenced in the summer of 2023 that was followed by 20 in-person engagements across the commonwealth

[00:39:52] over the course of six months in the winter and spring of 23 to 24, public comment, public hearing, and board approval of performance categories through early summer of 2024, and the board's ultimate approval in July and August of 2024 of the School Performance Support Framework Standards of Appreditation and the revised Essence State Plan. The data provided in this table reflects the typical collection of school performance data through September 30, 2024, and represents the number and percentage of elementary, middle, high, and unique configuration schools that would fall

[00:40:32] under the board-approved performance categories. And I will note that unique configuration schools refers to schools that don't typically fit the mold of your K-5 elementary, 6-8, middle, 9-12 high schools. We do have across the state K-3 schools, 7-12, K-8. So that is the notation on that column in the table. This, of course, includes the board-approved performance categories of distinguished on-track, off-track, and needs-intensive support categories if the 2023-2024 data were

[00:41:07] integrated into the newly adopted school and support performance framework. The predictive data shared with divisions is intended to support schools as they prepare for the 2025 implementation of the school performance support framework. As you can see, based on the September 30th final data roughly two-thirds of elementary and high schools and slightly more than half of our middle schools would be considered distinguished or on track if the school performance support framework was used to analyze 23-24 data there have been questions around how performance level

[00:41:42] category data has evolved since initial discussions which date back to the spring of 2024 but as the superintendent chad alderman and high slop have indicated to the board on several occasions, data was continuing to be collected as it is each year and fed into calculations, which has resulted in a more accurate and complete picture of performance levels in this simulation.

[00:42:08] Moving on, this is the what section of the hub. The SPSF hub contains a variety of resources responsive to many of the essential questions, decisions, and conversations that have transpired in the past several months.

[00:42:27] This includes, as you can see here, frequently asked questions, an overview of the more under the hood components of the framework, a detailed description of accountability and accreditation as unique bifurcated systems, a timeline of the engagement of the agency, board, and partners since summer of 2022, and specific documents outlining both mastery and growth components of the framework.

[00:42:50] These documents can be used by board members, superintendents, principals, anyone, and is readily available to teach and empower all members of school communities. And to dig in further on a few of these examples, the framework overview, for example, provides clear descriptions of the four performance categories, as well as details related to federal identification and MOU divisions.

[00:43:15] Framework weighting by level is described using clear, easy-to-understand visuals. And this resource, like all Hub resources, is intended to be easily understood by anyone, teacher, parent,

community partner, whether education is your business or not, and can be used to teach and empower on behalf of Virginia students.

[00:43:32] The Mastery Weight Index you see on the right is a great example of this transparent and understandable design. Rather than just provide a table with mastery performance-level weights, the resource walks the audience through the calculations step-by-step. And I will pass it to my colleague, Dr. Myers.

[00:43:55] Thank you. Good afternoon, members of the board. I'm going to talk a little bit about the data toolkit that's part of the hub. As part of our efforts to ensure school division personnel know what data goes into the SPSF and how that data interacts and is used to calculate the framework score, we have created this toolkit.

[00:44:18] Every division has access to every data element that goes into the framework and has been trained on how the numerator and denominator works for every indicator and ultimately is added to how it's ultimately added together for an overall framework score as you will see we have held 16

[00:44:41] regional superintendent trainings in all also holding weekly office hours we are also holding weekly office hours and we are doing personal individual meetings we've done over 40 of those and still counting. I have personally answered many emails and sat down with virtual calls with

[00:45:19] divisions spending upward of an hour more to help them understand exactly where the data are coming from and how they are used to calculate their school's framework scores. This level of outreach is unprecedented compared to years past and will continue and we will continue to do this until everyone's questions are answered. As part of the data toolkit in the SPSF hub, superintendents, test and data personnel, and principals can take their data they have in SSWS, which is our internal system that we use to deliver sensitive data, and they can start plugging these name

[00:45:58] numbers to get their numerator and denominator for each indicator that is then used to add together for an overall score. One of the best parts of this tool is not only will it allow you to understand and calculate your current framework score, but it will also allow you to change the numbers to forecast what, say, for instance, 10 more passing reading scores or seven more students meeting growth in math could mean for your overall score. Or you could decrease your chronic absenteeism in this tool by 3% and see how that would change the chronic absenteeism,

[00:46:34] indicator as well as the overall score so what i really like about this is school personnel including principals at the school level can calculate their own scores understand how it all works and even play around with it to see how they could improve their score by just adding to each indicator sorry i didn't advance the screen there on that um so as you can see also on this data calculation tool as the schools plug in there's there's multiple tools on here this is just an example of one of them but as schools plug in their information they simply add it's

[00:47:13] it's a pretty simple math equation at that point where they add their index scores together to get a final composite score the other thing that we've had of course before you start plugging these numbers you can use these resources on our tool our data our support data literacy that's in the toolkit you can use these tools to understand how every indicator is calculated and where that data is coming from. The data literacy tools also provide answers to frequently asked questions like, what happens to my EL score if I have less than 15 students and the indicator is

[00:47:50] missing? Or how is my school calculated if I have a combined school that may include a mix of elementary and middle school grades or middle and high school or even the occasional K-12 school that we have in Virginia? These tools are great self-help technical assistant tools that can be used along with the dozens and dozens of in-person sessions we have and will continue to do so that every school understands how this framework works and that they can be their own stewards of this data and that they can really use their own understanding to calculate and understand what their overall score is.

[00:48:28] I am now going to turn this over to the Deputy Superintendent of Teaching and Learning, M. Cooper, who's going to talk about the supports Virginia Learners tab in this hub. Good afternoon. So Dr. Armstrong explained what the accountability system is and the resources to support the framework. Dr. Myers explained, so what does the data mean? And I'm here to share now what? Now what does this mean for educators and families? The last three sections you see on

[00:49:04] the screen in the hub are the most important, and they're to empower educators and families to use the data to drive improvement for students in classrooms and at home. The Supporting Virginia Educators section provides four roadmaps for readiness, one for superintendents, one for principals, one for teachers, and one for parents.

[00:49:26] And these roadmaps guide users through steps to unpack the data and reports, create or update a plan for improvement, and then identify the supports and resources available to improve growth and proficiency in each school performance component. These roadmaps are a key resource for superintendents to use with their cabinet members to understand division-wide data, update their current continuous improvement plan, and what supports may be needed to include in their division plan or school-specific supports, which I'll walk through in just a moment, for

[00:50:04] their school leaders and principal supervisors. Principals can use their roadmap with their school instructional leadership team to understand their site-specific data across each school performance component and student group, update their school support plan, and then select from the resources and opportunities available from VDOE to include in that school's plan. Teachers can use their roadmap to drill down into their own students' data to understand growth and proficiency for each student in their class, update student-specific plans, and identify resources from VDOE to support

[00:50:41] their instruction in their classroom. And then finally, parents also have a roadmap to understand their child's assessment reports, create a plan for helping their own child, and then they are directed to the resources they can use to support learning in their home. The family supports page is a comprehensive one-stop shop for parents to learn more about their child's growth and proficiency, and the resources they can use at home to reinforce learning from their child's

[00:51:13] classroom. Families can access resources, tips, and activities to support their child at home in reading, math, science, absenteeism, and readiness. And in each of the content areas, materials are organized by grade band, making it user-friendly for parents. The pages also share what parents should expect at each grade band and content area, the milestones they should be looking for or seeing in their child as they achieve, and then tools for parent-teacher communication

[00:51:48] to discuss how their child is doing and what support they may need with their child's teachers. The Educator Supports page is a robust suite of resources for teachers and school leaders at all grade levels and school performance categories.

[00:52:07] Aligned to the data toolkit that Dr. Myers talked about earlier, each category of resources provides educators with the supports and opportunities organized by need. The content area pages of reading, math, and science focus on standards and curriculum implementation, effective instructional practices, and professional learning.

[00:52:32] Our team continues to be responsive to the field by adding supports and resources as we are getting input on the Hub. Dr. Myers and Dr. Armstrong are also providing technical assistance and office hours, as they mentioned. And we're also adding a button on the hub for parents and educators to request any additional supports or resources that they may need. We stand ready to support the field and school performance and support and strive for continuous improvement in all of our schools.

[00:53:00] Thank you all very much. Are there questions? I would like to just tell you guys and also give you maybe frame it in a question. So it seems like you all have taken quite a bit of time to really think through the specific needs of schools, what they might think about as far as questioning the very small specifics about, like Dr. Myers mentioned about, well, if I have 15 ESL students,

[00:53:38] what does that do? I'm very appreciative of that thought process that you all have put very, very detailed time and effort into. And I can tell by that that you all have been using those office hours, have been getting feedback on how to continuously improve this process so that, again, as the board has gone through this entire process, it has always been about transparency and how we can best help and support school divisions as they move to be their very

[00:54:16] best. So have you all gotten a lot of feedback and made a lot of, or at least made some changes to how you're presenting the data or how you're presenting the information for schools up to this point since this has been rolled out? I would say it's definitely been an iterative process along the way. Every time I meet with someone, I met with a school division for about an hour and 10 minutes late or early last week. Might have been right before Thanksgiving there. And I will just

[00:54:51] tell you the feedback I got was just really helpful. We were talking about IB students and how that works and with IB diplomas. And it was just really helpful to think through in the future how to communicate even more succinctly or better on what an IB diploma versus IB tests, the two various tests you can take, and how that combos with AP students.

[00:55:15] It's not really complicated. It's just it's something new that people are getting to understand. And so hearing how they received that and how then we can improve the documents that we're putting back out, absolutely, that's what we're trying to do.

[00:55:31] I actually look at this as a field test for me, right? Like I have hundreds of eyes looking at all of this right now. And that's what we want because we want this to be really good. And we want this to be something that accurately reflects schools across Virginia.

[00:55:49] So I actually, the more eyes on it, the better is the way I look at it. And so, yeah, we've received a lot of great feedback and we'll continue these sessions. I think by the time it's said and done, we will have probably met with all 131 school divisions individually by the time this is said and done, just to give them the time and information and expertise that they need.

[00:56:15] Thank you. Other questions? Ms. Holton? Thank you, Dr. Meyers and Timmy, for all this good work and for sharing it with us today. If you could go back to, I think it's slide five, the percentages, the age, performance levels.

[00:56:35] Thanks. Thank you. I know which one you're talking about. It'll just take me a second to get back to that slide here. When we saw this earlier iterations of this data this summer, and we're making decisions about their framework, we were also given modeling data that showed that our higher poverty schools were overrepresented among the needs intensive support and off-track schools and our wealthier schools were overrepresented among the distinguished and on-track schools.

[00:57:08] Have we done that? And now the numbers have changed quite dramatically overall. Have you done any new modeling data or is there, can we ask that we get new modeling data so as to understand whether this current version of the system is equally demographically skewed?

[00:57:30] I'm sorry, we're one of you going to... Okay, I'm happy to answer that. So as Dr. Armstrong mentioned earlier in his presentation, we did see quite a bit more data come in between the spring and early summer. There's lots of data that still comes in through... That's why we don't put accreditation out each year until September because all the data has to be finalized. So a lot of these changes occurred to that. And as you can imagine, if you had a school at 79 or 78 and something changed that and moved it up to an 80, you could have a good number of schools, which I suspect we did

[00:58:07] early in the spring, kind of at that threshold level. And some changes in data pushed that over so you can get changes like what we saw. We are not doing any other modeling right now. We have been doing a considerable amount of research on the model and making sure that these models are making sense. I will tell you some data I just looked at just recently even showed that there wasn't a lot of difference between EL schools with high EL populations and those without high

[00:58:42] EL populations, which was really good to actually see that kind of data. So we are seeing more and more things like that, but I'm not running any more modeling at this time. Well, that is actually an example of the kind of modeling I'd love to have us see. So for instance, what you've just described that you've done about EL students, if we could see that, that would be terrific. But also, I understand what you're saying about why there was some discrepancy, but to point out, I mean, discrepancy was quite sharp. We were told in August that we were being presented with data based on the 23-24 school year, and 60 plus percent of our schools were off track or

[00:59:21] needing intensive support. And now that number somehow magically changed to 30, 35 percent are in those two categories. So almost half, a huge difference. And so it seems to me that that would then behoove us to go back and look at some of those demographic questions to see maybe we've solved the problem of over-representation of poor kids in the more difficult categories, or maybe we haven't. And so the modeling you say you've just done about EL kids, I would love to have us see,

[00:59:59] but I would love to have you do the same modeling for economic demographics. Dr. Gaines? I just want to remind the board that early in the spring chad and ann cautious us around modeling and we use 23 data then we use partial data and they cautioned us each time chad presented the modeling data saying this was incomplete and want to reiterate what dr meyer said is we don't present accreditation data until the end of september because that is when schools finalize their data

[01:00:33] i also want to mention that you asked us to work on a system that creates transparency and identifies need identifies where that is and that was the goal of releasing the hub releasing the data to make sure our school divisions have the opportunity now to focus on their data focus on what their data is saying and focus on the school division's ability to make changes and impact and that is where the team is

focusing based on the board's decision to move forward in august and september so i just want to reiterate what chad and ann said all through the summer that this was

[01:01:08] early modeling data and none of it was complete we did not have finalized data until september 30th well some of that just some of that just some of that just begs the question for why we're rushing this before we have that modeling data i'm maybe the only board member that was involved in a prior round of changes to accreditation and we had all of that kind of modeling data before we made changes that would lead to my and i and i think that we still have huge transparency issues i do think you it's a huge advance that you've given the divisions the tools to make these calculations now, but without explaining what's going on in that black box that made things change so drastically

[01:01:48] from before, and frankly, without being more transparent to parents, I don't think that this is, if anything, this is a huge step backwards compared to our school quality profiles, for instance, that gave parents terrific transparency under the old system. But to bring it to a question. I know you've heard from divisions representing at least a third of our school students. The Region 4 divisions have submitted a letter requesting that we delay implementation for a year so as to enable them to make adjustments to get resources to the kids that need them the

[01:02:23] most to make the kind of changes you're suggesting they can make in the data to make that on the ground to a system that they were not told what the rules were going to be before they started this school year. Have you heard that request for delay from other divisions beyond those Region 4 divisions? And if so, are we considering delaying a year so as to allow the school divisions to implement changes on the ground to help improve their performance? Dr. Kins?

[01:02:53] Ms. Halton, thank you for that question. I think you're referring to a letter that had eight school board presidents i don't believe there are any school division superintendents that sign that eight out of 131 i just want to correct you said that was about a third of our school division those those eight divisions represent one third of the student body of the commonwealth of virginia they are the eight largest essentially the north the northern virginia divisions in region four include the largest divisions and therefore as their letter points out they represent a third of our students thank you for that clarification that there was a letter

[01:03:27] from eight school board presidents that asked for that you also said that there's less data now than there ever has been before i would disagree with that statement there is more data and more transparency available on our website for every single stakeholder than has ever been in the past i was misunderstood if i said there was less data i did say there's less transparency we have nothing equivalent to the school quality profiles that can allow parents teachers educators everybody to see easily how their school is doing, how their division is doing. I do believe that this

[01:04:02] whole process started based on us looking at all of those things and determining that it was very difficult for parents to understand that. This is more difficult. Mr. Rotherham. I saw Ms. Northern if I would yield and then at some point I'm hoping to say something. Sure. Dr. Northern. So I have spent a lot of time with the system in between our last meeting and this meeting because I had some questions of my own and was just trying to get to the bottom of things. Am I on? Oh, sorry.

[01:04:40] And I would say that all of my questions were answered. I had a long meeting with Dr. Myers, also talked to Dr. Coons about the questions that I thought that, you know, divisions might have.

[01:04:57] And I would say a few things I learned just for everyone's edification. One is, you know, some of the data that we're missing were the IB and the ASVAB data that have since come in. The other clarification I had was around 3E data because I was, I think reasonable people can disagree on whether kids should be triple counted.

[01:05:18] So in other words, if they get, you know, a point for taking an IB or a college board test and then they take the ASVAB test and then they do dual enrollment, you know, they're going to be triple counted. And I thought, I don't know about that. But then when I talked to Dr. Myers, he's like, it's an and model. And we do think that if kids do multiple of these things, then they should be rewarded for taking advantage of multiple opportunities. Now, one day districts may figure that out and they may end up gaming the system. And at that point, we would need to look at that again. And we've said all along, this is an iterative system and we'll, you know, learn from

[01:05:56] it as we go. And so my point in saying that is that we are going to make some adjustments along the way. We're going to evolve as the system ages. You know, we're kind of playing with a baby here and the baby's going to grow up and we're going to change, you know, some of the rules around that baby. That's a terrible metaphor, but you understand what I'm saying. So I think that, and I came back, I said, I don't, I don't understand this. You know, how is this, how, how does the denominator, because the denominator is a hundred. And that means that everybody has got to get a hundred, even if they don't have every single indicator. And then that indicator gets apportioned to other

[01:06:33] categories sometimes. So for instance, if they don't have the EL kids, some people may disagree. Some people would say, oh, we should, we should have a total. The total should change based on, you know, how many indicators they have. But we don't think that makes sense because then you'd have different numbers that would total for the distinguished and distinguished would be a different amount of points for elementary versus middle versus high school. So we decide to be more transparent and actually have it match up. So I would just say that all of these decision rules make sense personally to me now that I've had the time to actually ask every single decision rule that I wanted to know. And this is what's been explained to all these divisions. And I'm

[01:07:12] hoping that they're you know they're getting their questions answered as we go along so I will just say that I do think it's been transparent and these little template things that where districts can go in and add up and see that is a game changer for districts because it nails transparency to the wall they there will be no way they can go into this calculation sheet and have questions because it will very much say well the reason that this is this way is because you don't have enough ELO kids or whatnot. I've spent the time on it, so I feel very confident about that.

[01:07:48] Other thing, and just real briefly, I'll wrap it up, is I just am incredibly proud of this department. States, there are a handful of states that have had to take leadership roles at state agencies, and most state agencies are not equipped to lead. They don't have the talent, they don't have the manpower, they don't have the experience, and this department has really rose to to the occasion as a state agency.

[01:08:13] And they have really gone out on front of this and led, come up with an amazing number of resources in a short amount of time, yes, but they're also whole handing each district along with them, answering their questions, office hours, so on and so forth. So I just wanna say kudos to this department

on the role that they've taken as a leadership and that it's rare, honestly, across the country that state agencies are able to lead in this way.

[01:08:40] Ms. Ashton, or do you want to go? He's still faking his thoughts. No, I'm ready, but go ahead, go ahead. That's a tough act to follow, so you go ahead. Well, I was going to say double, double, double down with Amber said. And I think what is most impressive from my perspective is that it has kept all throughout the process every stakeholder in mind.

[01:09:06] when i look at the toolkit and it says parents educators teachers like everyone has a tool here and it's not just the administration or the state board and so again just thank you for your comprehensive work it's not going to be perfect but i do think given superintendents and teachers and parents the tools to begin to really unpack the data is what's going to exponentially move every kid board in Virginia and not just some of our scopes so thank you Andy's ready are you ready

[01:09:43] sure I will Mr Rotherham yeah I concur with with much of what my colleagues have said I just wanted to make three quick points first of all first one echoing a lot thank you all um really this is a fantastic model I think we will have to iterate on it and so forth but the degree of transparency the user friendliness it's really fantastic it's the direction we should be going as a commonwealth in providing more data more information and so like the announcement was exciting being able to the presentation day and be able to use this so that's that's fantastic um uh and very much appreciated second uh just to like ground this again in some data i i have trouble following

[01:10:22] aspects of this conversation we live in a commonwealth by the time kids get to eighth grade on the nape about half of our kids are below basic about 51 percent are at basic or above so Below basic, again, you can argue about the NAEP levels. There is no disagreement that below basic is just not an acceptable place for us to have kids at, especially kids we've had for so long. You're basically unprepared for any of the kinds of opportunities we're talking about in post-secondary, whether it's college, careers, the military.

[01:10:53] So we keep saying, well, we're going to identify these schools. That 50% of kids, they go to school somewhere in this state, right? And so any accountability system that's being honest, we're going to identify a lot of schools that are underserving these kids.

[01:11:08] And again, it's a kind of a gut check moment. We can continue to come at this from what do the divisions think? What do the divisions want? What does it look like? Or we can come at it from what are the actual results we're getting? and what do we need to do to get serious about improving opportunities and outcomes for those kids? And we go around on this again and again. And with respect, I get why the divisions want to delay. If I were some of those divisions, I would want to delay too, because disaggregated accountability reveals some uncomfortable things about some of the stories we've been telling.

[01:11:38] And this goes back to No Child Left Behind. We tried to disaggregate. We couldn't do it. We had to always try to stay ahead. We're now doing it again. We either step up and confront this, And as leaders get serious then about what are the things we need to do, or we just continue to try to figure out what's the story we want to tell, what's easier for the adults.

[01:11:55] And so I just, I'm glad we have this. I do think it cannot get divorced from this larger picture, which even despite some of the changes we've made over the last decade that lowered standards, you know, and you can see the results on, you know, with our, where our cut scores line up with other states.

[01:12:11] Our state tests tell this too. It's not just the NAIT. And so we need to engage with that. There's work we have to do. That's a separate conversation. There's work we have to do there on our own tests, but we have to engage with where that data is or act. And I hope that we can, as a Commonwealth, come together and act on that and not continue to sort of kick this can down the road because it's underserving these kids.

[01:12:35] It's been underserving them for a long time. And the problem is particularly acute now with what we know about what happened with the pandemic. It's also what we know about just the importance of education. So it's a tremendous opportunity. You all have done a small part, but really important part in helping present that data.

[01:12:51] So hopefully we can have a conversation across the Commonwealth about that. So thank you, Ms. McPherson. And then Dr. Bryce, I want to thank the staff as well for the immense amount of work that's gone into creating this data. I have to agree that we still have a lot of work to do, and especially since we recognize that maybe some of the data is going to shift a bit as we continue to go through it.

[01:13:16] I looked at the off-track numbers and the needs and intensive support numbers. And when you combine those numbers for each one of the categories, we still have, for instance, with elementary schools, we still have elementary schools, 365 schools that are either off-track or needs and intensive support out of 1,111 schools, which puts that roughly at about 33 percent and middle school we're at 44 percent between those two categories

[01:13:54] and high schools we're at least at 33 percent so obviously there's still a lot of work to be done with these school areas so regardless of the fact that we got the raw numbers I'm more concerned about we got that many institutions that are still on a day-to-day basis not quite where we want them to be. I'm hoping that the use of the resources is going to help improve these numbers, but I agree with Mr. Rottenham that at some point we really got to drill down there and figure out

[01:14:32] where we're going to place the resources because we got to get intensive support schools off of that track at least. They got to move up two levels to be on track and off track. Students got to move up at least a minimum of one whole uh division in order to be on track um i'd like to see everybody in a distinguished category but we are where we are dr bryce and dr fans um i want to echo my fellow board members and just applaud you all on this work um i think the hub exceeded

[01:15:09] my expectations at least and um one of the things i really appreciate is how intuitive it is and that you know for um educators it's arranged by content area whereas for family it's arranged by grade level looking at the family supports page this would have been a total game changer as a parent during the pandemic being able to look okay what exactly should my kid be learning right now um especially when school like you know when schools were first closed and there was no online school there was nothing this would have been a dream to have something like this so thank you um

[01:15:44] I have two questions. First is, because I think this information is so rich for parents, what is the plan? I know you've been doing a ton of work with school divisions, getting this information out. What's the plan for getting this information out to parents and making sure that they're aware of it and, you know, know how to use it? And then my second question is, all of the educator supports, and there are a lot on there.

[01:16:15] uh obviously our teachers don't have more hours in the day now so how can we support teachers in learning about this and implementing it in their classroom can we have um maybe you're already planning on this will there be some like uh incorporation of this stuff in teachers professional development days so they can learn about this during time that's already set aside for them um yeah i'm i'm just wondering about outreach both to parents and to teachers oh wait one more

[01:16:49] question the the people who are attending the info sessions are they who is it generally is it um like people from central office or is it superintendents principals teachers all of the above yeah i can answer that one real quickly it's been mostly so far what's known as a ddot um also other key leaders school counselors um we've also had uh there have been some principles that have been on we've had a lot of superintendents we it was dr coons was very intentional from the beginning that this would be from a top you know the the lead that the superintendent knows how

[01:17:25] it needs to know how to calculate this and many of them do it's pretty impressive how many of them have really dug in and looking at the denominator and numerator of all these indicators so it's been a pretty mixed bag i think division data personnel and testing coordinators the d dots they're the ones that have kind of traditionally done this across the the state um and so there's there's quite a bit of train the trainer i think going on with that yeah so i think um as dr meyer said our first round was really focusing on superintendents and making sure they understood and could use those calculator tools and really had a grasp on their data and so we've shifted

[01:18:05] and had several principals training i think andy and i i think we have one another one for elementary school principals this week and now you're going to hear from learning heroes this afternoon to talk about our next wave is to really getting information out to parents and families and doing that and i think once we have a tipping point with superintendents and principals they design those professional development days and those support days we can start sitting down with our regional superintendents and moving into those stakeholders so thank you for calling those out madam president miss holton i have one comment and one question my comment is just

[01:18:41] to say i think it's unfair to suggest inappropriate motives and not that you all did but i'm challenging my fellow board members i'm sure you didn't mean to suggest inappropriate motives on behalf of these school board leaders who have asked for delay i am absolutely confident they have asked for delay because they want to do the very best by all of our students and because they want to be able to support their teachers they may see that differently than you but it's not because they want to cover up problems they are in the field every day trying to get the very best education to all of our kids and i have complete confidence in our school division leaders

[01:19:18] that as to their motivation whether or not they agree with you as to the the mechanics of of how we implement all of this my one specific question i wanted to ask is uh it has been brought to my attention since we adopted this new system you know we have a major change in how we're evaluating english language learners and we were told that most of the other states are doing it the way we are now doing it which is aligning the three semesters to the federal requirements but i am it's been brought to my attention that most of the other states also offer native language testing

[01:19:52] options to students in whose native who are more comfortable taking for instance their math and science tests in Spanish or Arabic, whatever. If they're literate in their native language, they're given those options for testing, and that that's apparently the case in the majority.

[01:20:09] All those states that are doing it the way we are now transitioning to do it, many of them, most of them are offering native language testing. Is that an alternative that we will be able to offer to our english language learners this year or will we be able to or is there anything we can do to expedite it so they can be offered that option next year dr coons thank you for that question miss holton um we did in the rfa process and in the presentation ask for the cost of what it would be to offer math science and social studies and native languages

[01:20:48] that will be part of the rfi report when we have that opportunity and part of the rfp considerations for assessments so we can't get i mean that report was that report was due november 1st we still don't have it it's over a month overdue we can't get an answer to that question in the meanwhile can our students or is that yet another reason for delay if we can't yet offer what other states are offering to their english language students is that yet another reason why we should take the time to get this right thank you for your question miss holton i want to reiterate that was part of

[01:21:24] the budget request that does cost an additional amount to run those assessments in different languages the rfi report is currently with the attorney general when we get the green light we will submit that it sure seems like we got a lot of reasons to delay and that reminds me i never got an answer i'm sorry to my first question of we know that school board leaders representing a third of the student body in virginia have asked that we take more time to get this right have you heard from other school division leaders superintendents or school board members

[01:21:57] as part of your feedback suggesting uh that we need more time i will say i heard that um early on before all the data and the trainings had gone out. I don't hear that as much now. I think they've seen it, and they recognize that it's here. It's not an area we've heard a lot of the last several weeks or that we're really focused on. We've been more intentional on this is the task we have to do, and this is what we want to help you to understand. So I personally have not

[01:22:32] heard that a lot over the last several weeks, whereas I did hear it before all this information was put out. If I may just suggest that everybody do take time to read that letter from the school board leaders, because it's not just, it's not just, we don't want to, it's not at all we don't want accountability. It's we want good, effective accountability, and we want to be able to do, take steps like give professional development to our teachers, which we do before the school year starts mostly to help them adjust to this new system. We want to be able to work to have more algebra teachers. We want to make accommodations so as to adjust to the new system. They're not

[01:23:11] asking for delay for delay's sake. Ms. Holton, if you did not receive the other school board members from around the Commonwealth's email, I'd be happy to share them with you. Most of them described our work as very intentional and very important for this time that while they understand the request for some of these other school board members across the Commonwealth, mainly in Northern Virginia, I think only in Northern Virginia that have made that

[01:23:41] request, those reasons they feel are even more important now because our kids can't wait. We, just like Mr. Rotherham said, we have to do what we have to do to get our students prepared for life beyond the walls of our schools.

[01:24:05] I hope and trust the other comments will be uploaded. What I've looked at is what's on our public comment website. And I have not seen those on our public comment website. So hopefully they will be uploaded there. I believe we as board members, Dr. Dice. Yeah, we as board members have received

several emails from school board members, yeah, applauding the new framework and saying that they don't agree with the school divisions asking for more time and that they know

[01:24:39] that it's going to be tough work, but they're ready to do it. Thank you. Mr. Hanson. Thank you as well. I just am very grateful for the work and I know the board has been pushing this, but just grateful for the work around the Commonwealth and all the listening and adapting that you've made

[01:25:03] And I would like just to, you know, in terms of casting motives, I think some of the terminology that's been used that the last couple of months that the system has been gained, that's questioning people's motives or work, frankly.

[01:25:22] And I just am very appreciative of the trusted work that's gone into this and, again, the listening that's gone into it. And also, I just, in terms of delay, and I think Dr. Bryce just hit it, though, that we have tens of thousands of reasons to move forward.

[01:25:44] and those are our children, the ones that Mr. Rotherham talked about earlier, the ones that already were not proficient in math or reading, and again, have declined significantly. And just again, a generation of our students are at risk here. And so I think that we owe it to those tens of thousands of students that need to get to the proficient levels in reading and math. And frankly, the hundreds of schools up here i don't you know no matter what uh some of the differences uh you

[01:26:21] know might be in perspective we can't wait another year and we're going to lose another cohort and tens of thousands of more students so i just really again uh appreciate the terrific work that's gone into this and look forward to moving forward and um and again if we wait for perfection you know we can be here 20 years from now talking about this and we need to move ahead and i think is the baby example that we've had we've got to you know learn to um you know walk and run and

[01:26:58] this is just an incredible start and we've got to get this pushed forward and our system has to change for the benefit of our students and our families and and frankly for our schools which are you know pillars in the community and so i really look forward to moving this process ahead mr rotherham thank you madam president yeah i want to just uh respond to one thing i want to correct the record on one thing i said i said a small part and i did not mean to that this was a small amount of work it was a huge amount of work what i meant was it is a small part of what is

[01:27:35] going to be a very substantial culture change systems change it is not something that's going to happen with one board one governor one legislative session if we if we go down this route it's it's a long-term uh it's a long-term process that's what i meant which brings me back to miss holton i will say i do believe we have in the state a culture of adult politics uh driving a lot of our education decisions that hardly makes us unique you can ask any political scientist uh worth his or her salt that's what you get in most states that's education politics and it's it's not

[01:28:09] about motives it's just about we spend a lot of time talking about well if we label schools if we what's this going to do what are people all just all kinds of adult and that's not by the way a democrat thing a republican thing it's just a thing that happens in education because as you'll note there's no little people here i'm not even sure there's anybody representing little people here because we don't have groups like that uh here in the commonwealth so it's just the thing

[01:28:34] And so it falls to us to say, where do we need to keep our eye? What's the North Star? And so forth. And it doesn't make people, it's not about good people, bad people, anything else. It's just the way

the system works. And if we want to be serious about student outcomes, we have to find ways to auger against that good data and transparency.

[01:28:54] And I will note, for examples of that, when we were doing a combined rate that led to these weird outcomes where schools would have half of kids passing, yet it would appear that almost all the kids were passing and they were fully accredited. No one was coming and saying, oh, this isn't transparent. This is creating problems.

[01:29:09] Nobody was here when we had to go back and say, what has happened with cut scores and so forth. Nobody was saying, oh, that's not transparent. Let's not do that. Like, it's just the way the system works, and it falls to this board right now to say, are we going to sort of continue that, or are we going to start to try to build this broader culture and really pay attention to outcomes?

[01:29:31] So I'd be careful about how we frame it. I don't think anybody has bad motives, but it's just a thing of how the system works. It's a thing of how any large system works, and our job is to regulate a large system, and this is a small but really important step in that direction.

[01:29:45] all this work comprehensively is a very big thing okay miss mcpherson i think it would be important if we just issued a letter to them asking that they come in for intensive training demand me

[01:30:21] whether you know you set up a workshop for them for instance that the principles of superintendents that wrote the letter but i think the road meets the road so we're going to be asking them to do their part as well and i know that you're doing a lot of it by outreach but where there is a a complaint i think we address it straight on and we say then you need to come in and we need to have an intensive session with your school division and make sure that you understand where the board is and where the policy is and you understand all of the inner workings and then at least we would have done our part as it relates to those types of concerns dr james dr meyers i think you have met

[01:30:59] with several northern virginia i think you spent several hours with prince william and a few other school divisions in Northern Virginia. Is that correct? Yeah, I mean, we've had multiple engagements with folks in Northern Virginia. I can think of two or three superintendents off the top of my head that I've had long, extensive conversations with. I don't get a sense from them. It's a lack of understanding of what's in the system. I just, there are some out there, but not the folks that we were just speaking of. That's just been my impression, But that's just me, right?

[01:31:32] There may be a lot of misunderstanding that I'm not aware of, but. Madam President. Mr. Rotherham and then Ms. Colton. I just have a question. Are we planning to do, I mean, the superintendents, I think that's great. And we should obviously provide, and you all are doing great work and are generally very responsive.

[01:31:49] What are we doing on the media, though? Are we going to do any kind of like a media, I know there was a media briefing attached to release, anything else to make sure they understand what is going on and what is not going on and all of that? Because that's another audience, that's a way, I mean, we're going to hear later today from about sort of how parents receive information.

[01:32:08] But one way is obviously the media making sure that they're getting their questions answered. And so we're getting stories that are as accurate as possible. That's good feedback. Thank you. Just to, again, if you take a chance to read the letter from the Region 4 divisions, it's not, the framework that you've rolled out now is helpful.

[01:32:33] these resources are helpful, but one of their points is it would have really been helpful to have all that before the school year started so they could have trained people on it, so they could have taken steps to adjust their professional development, so they could have taken steps to adjust their curriculum, for instance, English language learners, math, etc., so that they could have taken steps to try to convince their local divisions, local authorities to provide more supports. I mean, some of these things cost money to do better by some of our students. We need to

[01:33:09] do extended school year, for instance, which costs money. And they also are asking for more time for the state to come in with its share of supports. And I think the governor recognizes and said when he had rolled all this out that he recognized there's going to be a need for more investment in some of these divisions. But that money won't come until a year late. So the point of the waiting is not just delay for the sake of delay, but rather let's put the supports in so that the supports coincide and so that we have the modeling data and that so that we're vetting it. You know, in addition to all the changes we're making here, we're making changes to our testing

[01:33:48] system. And we're behind the schedule for work we should be doing on that, as we have discussed amongst ourselves, but I'm not sure it's publicly been shared yet. We're not going to set new pass rates because we don't have time to get it done in time, essentially, for this year's test administration. So we're going to use the old pass rates, even though we have new standards and new testing elements based on the new standards. So there's all kinds of things we're behind on because we've taken on too much all of these changes should have been implemented but well

[01:34:21] before the school year started so that school divisions could have a year to prepare for miss ashton madam president i just want to have clarity on where we are on the discussion i think board members have had a chance to ask staff provide comment and just would like to check where we are yeah i don't think that we need to continue to rehash old things um for the purpose of you know having a microphone so at this time we're going to move to the next item but i'd like to take a

[01:34:55] quick five minute break please thank you so really excited um to bring the board an item

[01:51:13] for discussion this is not an item for voting um as everyone knows house bill 1477 asked the board to work on seat time flexibility so we've had a lot of input and a lot of opportunity from the field to start thinking about where seat time flex was prior to that legislation and feedback on that space dr armstrom is going to bring to you today what we're hearing some key decision points and thought partnership that we need your help with the board thank you dr coons madam president and board members i would like to as mentioned guide our conversation with this

[01:51:50] a very early draft of the agency's work to implement the provision of seat time flexibility to Virginia schools per now enacted HB 1477. Today's conversation will inform our plans to provide the board with an item for first review in February. Again, this is an early draft and your feedback and discussion will be critical to our next steps. As a reminder, HB 1477 outlines seat time flexibility for options to allow students with time during the school day to complete work-based learning opportunities, advanced learning opportunities focused on the five Cs,

[01:52:26] Competency-based learning opportunities, alternative programs such as dual enrollment courses, other instructional time models focused on project-based learning, mastery-based learning, and or weekend and evening courses, and full-year innovative advanced and enrichment programs.

[01:52:42] Again, this is, I'll say it again, an early draft year feedback and consideration and preparation for anticipated first review in February, and we want to first provide you all with a draft definition. Defining CTIME flexibility will be essential to thoughtful implementation and framing for schools.

[01:53:00] A definition for discussion is provided on this slide, and I will read it to you. It states that CTIME flexibility empowers Virginia school divisions to provide all students with personalized and mastery-based learning opportunities based on their individual needs. These models prioritize student outcomes and mastery of academic content over fixed instructional hours, allowing students to advance at their own pace, participate in innovative learning experiences and access tailored support while maintaining alignment with Virginia's SOLs for K-12.

[01:53:30] This definition would recognize four primary models of seat time flexibility. Those include alternative hours, mastery-based learning, project-based learning and remote learning. These are designed to meet the diverse needs of students and uphold best instructional practices, especially for students with disabilities and English learners, while ensuring transparent, regular assessment of progress toward SOLs. The draft notice form, which you'll find attached in your agenda, has been designed responsive to feedback on the existing waiver processes.

[01:53:58] That feedback has highlighted clarity and simplicity of the application process, potential replication, support and sustainability of innovative models, management of public comment and oversight at the local school board level for flexibility, flexibility in the scale of the opt-in, individuals, which would include individual schools or clusters of schools or even whole divisions, and a desire to allow flexibility of iteration without restrictions.

[01:54:23] The board has been provided with the notice form for review, so we can take a moment to review that and dig in a bit. The notice form includes three sections: a demographic section, a brief narrative on the model, and an achievement focus, which will require school leaders to explain how student achievement will occur in lieu of the 140 clock hour requirement.

[01:54:48] As we continue to implement seat time flexibility and work with the board and schools to provide support, best practice and guidelines will be developed and included to support schools. Several states that currently serve as national leaders in seat time flexibility, including Arizona, Utah, and North Dakota, have been studied to inform our work and will continue to be visited as efforts continue.

[01:55:08] Our membership in the launch innovation cohort includes opportunities as well to thought partner with several states in this space as seat time flexibility will be an important tool for us to strengthen sustainable career pathways through work-based learning, early post-secondary credits, earning credentials, and our 3E outcomes.

[01:55:26] As mentioned previously, we propose to recognize four primary models of seat-time flexibility, including alternative hours, mastery-based learning, project-based learning, and remote learning. And I'll get into those models now and provide a few examples under each of those if there are any questions so far.

[01:55:46] All right. Questions? Yes, ma'am. Ms. Holton. Just so I understand, the concept is that this is going to be local option, essentially. Either divisions and or a school or a group of schools will apply?

[01:56:02] That is correct. And is that contemplated in the statute that it would be that kind of local option? Yes, ma'am. And there is nothing restricting us from making it so in the statute. The idea is to

make this less bureaucratically cumbersome rather than the existing waiver process.

[01:56:19] So the one question I would have, and maybe you'll get to this later, so tell me if I should wait, but if we're doing something that's essentially some divisions are going to step up and essentially pilot this, I think that's a great way to learn and great way to innovate is to pilot in some divisions the volunteers first.

[01:56:39] But are we then, are we going to build in the thing we often fail here in Virginia and across the country to do is to build in some study to determine outcomes so that if it's, if the innovations are successful, that we can spread and make sure students all across the Commonwealth get access to those options.

[01:56:59] So are we building in the study component? Yes, there is a slide a ways down in the presentation that outlines some of what our goals will be around data collection. So Dr. Armstrong, I want to yield to Dr. Kuhn's in a minute, but we are not restricting this to just a pilot. We had a number of school divisions that are already, that have already implemented similar types of programs, alternative programs that actually came to the table and said, this is something that we want to help move out into the greater Commonwealth by way of this statute.

[01:57:34] And so it's been super successful for them, their large divisions and small divisions. I actually met with several of those school divisions and had long conversations about exactly what this looks like for them, how successful it has been, and talked to a wide array of people in their central office staff and in their building staff that explained just how critical this is to some of their students that need the opportunities that are available by way of this particular opportunity here that we're talking about today.

[01:58:14] And I'm sorry, I used the word pilot wrongly, so thank you for helping clarify that. The distinction I was looking for is local option versus statewide requirements, and we may someday want to require that all our divisions offer these options. But one way to get there is to study them and show how productive they are. And I will say some of the, one of the main things that we did learn from our division partners that had, that we had conversations with

[01:58:47] was around how we articulate the use of a waiver or alternative option. And because they said that sometimes their school boards or parents may think that they're getting out of some kind of requirement when that's, in fact, not the case at all. So those were some conversations that I just wanted to make sure that everybody knew we had, you know, at different times from, which has been the iterative process of getting to where we are with this particular presentation. Dr. Coons?

[01:59:23] I think in addition, and I believe I sent this out to the board, but I can do it again. We did, during the pandemic, do a personalized learning study called Bridging the Gap in a partnership with William & Mary and did study and find results. So happy to share that with the board. So we do have a pilot that occurred post-pandemic with Bridging the Gap and personalized learning, but I'm happy to share that with the board. And this really grows out of that work as well.

[01:59:53] Oh, no, no worries. Please continue. Sure. And I will add, in the not-so-distant past, having been a principal in a fairly high-need school, if you had given me the opportunity to implement dyslexibility in my school, and again, you don't know what you don't know, and not having an opportunity and the things that, in retrospect, that I could have done that would have made a difference for kids would have been pretty powerful.

[02:00:15] So I'm very excited about this. And I'm going to throw a lot of examples at you, but again, interrupt it anytime so we can dig in further on these. Alternative hours. That gives flexibility in timing and scheduling of instruction, which includes non-traditional times.

[02:00:31] That could be evenings, weekends, extended periods beyond the traditional academic or assessment calendar. This could also include scheduling courses for completion and fewer than the traditional hours provided students demonstrate their SLO competency mastery. Included are two examples for alternative hours.

[02:00:48] If middle and high school schedules are different, for example, in a school division, which is a common occurrence, middle school students are taking a high school credit earth science course at the middle school rather than focus on the consistency and the number of seat time hours between middle and high school coursework mastery can be determined for both middle and high school through earning of credits on a common assessment for cte and a different example if a student is completing a paid internship for a bulk of the morning that limits their course taking during normal school hours seat time flexibility could expand hours beyond the normal school time i do know that for example for pharmacy tech there's over 200 required clinical hours to achieve that credential

[02:01:26] so you know this ties into our work around 3e making sure the students are on sustainable pathways so this does not exist in isolation it's part of our larger portfolio around pathways right now so those are alternative hours i'll move to mastery based learning this allows students to progress at their own pace and prioritizes learning paths rigorous standards and frequent assessments to ensure deep mastery of content, not with the limits of clock hour requirements.

[02:01:53] In high school, an example would include providing an advanced mathematics AP course, which could set students up for success when they get to the AP Calculus B and C content. Students could demonstrate mastery through formative and diagnostic assessments to demonstrate mastery prior to getting into that AP course, which will again set them up potentially for greater success when they are sitting for the AP exam. Flexible learning settings can include remote opportunities which was mentioned initially. Work-based learning and apprenticeships partnering with coursework in an alternative setting as well as school within a school learning can provide students in small groups with innovative and personalized learning environments that do not

[02:02:31] necessarily have to be within the walls of traditional school building. These models prioritize smaller learning communities and give teachers the opportunity to utilize innovative practice. A few other examples include what you would find in several divisions including in louisa county where teachers for tomorrow's students would spend their days on site at a child care center involved in work-based learning in the morning and managing the child care center and then could take their traditional courses that are required on the same site without the burden of transportation back and forth between facilities school within a school models could be house plans which you see in a lot of schools nowadays that create smaller experiences for

[02:03:11] students whether those are at risk students trade clusters gifted or career academies or even fine arts partnerships with local businesses this can again instead of having to make choices as a student or a school to to give one opportunity and sacrifice another this will allow us to really combine those models and give students everything they need divisions can also develop partnerships with local businesses and organizations to apply instruction to coordinated workplace experiences aligned to

individual goals giving choice in how to gain credits and satisfy high quality work-based learning which includes internships or apprenticeships and project-based

[02:03:47] learning would engage students in hands-on, inquiry-driven projects to address real-world problems. This emphasizes critical thinking, collaboration, creativity, product development, and/or presentations to demonstrate competency mastery across many subject areas. Some examples of project-based learning could include students choosing a social issue that affects their local community, they can gather data, analyze related challenges and potential solutions, and then master computer science and english language arts as well as in the process year-round learning could include summer school additional learning weeks or high dosage tutoring

[02:04:26] without the pressure of the regular assessment timeline rather than starting over from the beginning for a student students could be provided with additional time to demonstrate mastery and ideally get back on track with their classmates rather than being held back and having to start the course over again in august or september um as dr armstrong just kind of talked through some of of those examples, some of those models, one of the things that we need to think about as a board and one of the things we want to bring to the board was the attachment with this, which was the notice form, and thinking about how we, as Member Holton mentioned, help school divisions think about these things, help them think about whether or not they want to do these things. So

[02:05:06] if we could take a minute and pull up the notice form and kind of dig into the notice form and get some feedback now that Dr. Armstrong's talked about all the different things, whether it's a year-long model where students get three to five additional weeks before they would have to take their SOLs to have a summer program and study, or it's having a school within a school and them having a fine arts project, or as Dr. Armstrong mentioned, the Louisa County model where students are on-site taking their courses in a workforce setting. All of those are just simple examples of all the different ways, and I know we have a lot of expertise on this board, whether it's

[02:05:41] Mache STEM School or some of the work that Debbie Kilgore did in Scott County. There are a lot of different expertise on the board. We really want to lean into your knowledge. And I know, Ms. McPherson, you've done a lot of work with workforce. We'd love your thoughts and engagement on helping us look at this form. One of the things that we did here around the past waiver form, as President Creasy said, was that the form was hard and that it was cumbersome and it pulled people away from that so some of the things we heard on this form is making sure the application

[02:06:15] is clear and simple and as an application more of a notice than a waiver process allow for replication so if you want to do a model multiple schools you can click on multiple schools or a cluster of schools you don't have to keep repeating information in that notice and that as um miss holton said how do we support the sustainability how do we learn from it how do we study how do we collect the data how do we make public comment and oversight through the local school board the regulatory flexibility then asking teachers or principals to manage all of the processes that

[02:06:50] go with that and then how do we allow for individual individual schools and then clusters of schools to join and then we want to make sure this is able to be an iterative process and that our schools are able to learn so if we could pull up that notice and talk a little bit through that notice that would be really helpful and i apologize it's not embedded in the presentation but no it is the attachment so it's not the presentation it's attachment one under b so thank you i was uh

[02:07:26] looking at it two quick questions one i um appreciated the attendance requirement because that was one thing it's like how are you going to track it or are kids just going to be sitting home or do they do their work so if you could talk a little bit about that if um and then i think one thing i'm wondering about is this a an individual child a school decides it's an individual child needs a program or is it hey we have a group of kids who we want to put in workforce and so we are kind of creating an alternative path for a group of kids

[02:08:02] how how should we think about it that's why we're here is to talk through this dr parents yeah i I think you could do either, right? You could do this for a cluster of students. You could do this for a student. You could do this for a cluster of schools. So if we look at the Hampton City schools and the academy model and some of the work they've done around clustering schools to do things differently, I think the innovation field is open and we need our schools to innovate and we need to learn from that. But at the same time, we want to collect their attendance. So their attendance might look different. So if I'm having alternative school hours and I go from 11 to four. I still need to be there during my alternative school hours that are designed in

[02:08:38] my plan. I might not be physically in a seat in room 104C, but I need to be able to demonstrate that I've attended and done the work that was outlined in my plan. One last thing. The only thing I do wonder is just about the parental. I don't know if I saw anything related to either of parental sign-off or partnership or something that just ensures that parents know what's going on so they're not kind of surprised like, well, why did I get that diploma and that kind of thing? Yeah, I think it's in there, but it's a good point that it's buried and not

[02:09:15] clear and elevated. So we need to, I think it's in the assurances just as a checklist, but bringing that up to the forefront might be really important. we're on a more practical level where is my kid like now are they at the child care center or are they at the school that's a valuable point i do think that one of the um some feedback that i heard about this is just that um as as far as the positive goes is that you know sometimes in the apprenticeship category you know kids need the they need to be there during those business hours

[02:09:52] When we have plenty of people within the community that are willing to help support apprenticeships, but they can't leave their job to go and sit in a classroom and directly instruct students when they can instruct them in real life situations that are going on in their businesses.

[02:10:12] And so this really gives that opportunity both to get that hands-on work experience while at the same time completing the required coursework.

[02:10:23] Yeah, let me just add, I'm really, really excited about this. I currently have seniors in our first class of seniors right now in my school, and all of them want to work. But because they have seat hour requirements that they have to be in school and we're tracking attendance, we're not able to be as innovative in terms of they could have a workplace experience where they're getting paid, but also learning and getting credit for it.

[02:10:54] And so I think that this flexibility without going too far, trying some things, I think it's going to allow for industry and partners to come to the table because, I mean, I know now high school kids, they want to work and they want to have meaningful jobs.

[02:11:14] And if schools can partner with certain organizations, I think the sky's the limit. so i'm really really excited by this and what it could mean for partnership and for kids who who aren't just like learning differently but uh kids who are advanced so we've got kids in dual dual enrollment who are like really should be off to college already but they're they're not quite ready so now they can um continue to advance but also have this work-based experience i heard some staff that said you know by the time they get to college they're going to change their career for their major six times well they could change it six times in high school and then

[02:11:52] actually go into college really knowing what they want to do which i think could be great well dr kentz and um miss ashton that is definitely something we've heard as we've been talking about the 3e readiness framework is we want this flexibility how do we get this flexibility we have seat time hours how do i make algebra fit into algebra so that we can have those great apprenticeships and internships so that was something we've also heard a lot from our advanced students in middle school how do i fit this advanced coursework in how do i accelerate based on mastery or in elementary school i've got a group of kiddos who want this fine arts experience

[02:12:29] how do i create a micro school or a school within a school so we're really excited as well because this is really iterative to what we're hearing in the field and from our families i love this cooking outside the box i know for so long we've stayed inside the box and as a former cte teacher as uh she alluded to you know i taught career exploration tell all the career courses and for a long time we had it set up not just for seniors but we had it for younger students to do job shadowing experiences for half a day took a lot of coordination a lot of businesses as you said wanted kids to you know find out because if they find these things out before they're seniors and

[02:13:09] they do job shadowing maybe they thought this was the career they wanted but then they spent some time doing that it may change their mind and a whole different uh path you know to what they want to do but then you then we would get to where you know if the pendulum was between and then all of a sudden we couldn't let them miss school miss seat time to go do the job shadowing so not you know this is not just about uh it is about career exploration but it's also it doesn't have to wait till they're seniors to start and i'm i'm happy to see having been on both sides i'm happy to see

[02:13:45] that we're thinking outside the box again what's best for students and i had so many seniors as michelle pointed out who were ready ready to go but our guidelines said nope you've got to be in the classroom all day long you can't leave so um i know there's a lot of school systems doing some innovative things i would like to hear from some of those and maybe that's part of your office plan to um because we learn from each other and you know i had a college professor who have quoted many times who said don't recreate the wheel and there's so many things going on in the nation and

[02:14:20] in the state that other school systems maybe haven't thought of or or haven't seen it implemented in the way it's implemented and it would be excited to see you know another school system so i think it's great and i'm excited about it thank you dr northern so nobody's more excited than me but let me point out what happens sometimes okay and and i'd like to just pair this with a request that, to Ms. Kilgore's point, that we talked to some other states, you know, perhaps at our next meeting. There's an organization called Knowledge Works that's working with North Dakota and

[02:14:57] Florida and Utah and Arizona and all these states that are doing this work. And for all these reasons, you know, other states get really excited about it. You know, the kids need more time to do CTE,

the graduation requirements get in the way, so on and so forth. But I just jotted down what I see as four challenges. One, sometimes you don't have high quality instruction and it gets watered down. And the high school graduation diploma means even less than it sometimes means. So we've got to make sure we've got to plan for high quality instruction. Two, evidence of learning. Sometimes these kids are trying to demonstrate skills and the testing hasn't caught up with the mastery.

[02:15:35] So we actually have no way to assess whether they've learned yet. So, you know, you've sometimes you've got to have discrete tests that are sort of assess, assess a set of skills and that test doesn't exist yet. Third is sometimes public colleges and universities get real confused about what to do with this. Like, do they, do they actually accept these hours or do they not? And what kind of guidance do we give our public universities and colleges about these types of credits? And then there's always the equity and access question that some of these, you know, you do see some districts and kids get less opportunity for these flex learning opportunities.

[02:16:09] So these are all the challenges that other states have, you know, worked with, and so I personally wouldn't, I mean, I feel desperately that we need to hear from KnowledgeWorks or any of these states about, that have been doing this five, ten years, about how they have tackled these challenges and more.

[02:16:27] Dr. Cairns? Yeah, we've worked very closely with North Dakota, Utah, and North Dakota is the one who worked very closely with KnowledgeWorks and Arizona. We can put something together. I just have a practical question.

[02:16:43] On the form, it shows like, you know, school cluster as cluster of schools. Can that cross division boundaries? So could there be schools like city of Charlottesville is surrounded by Albemarle County. So Albemarle County students could be crossing through the city of Charlottesville to get to their work opportunity that, you know, city of Charlottesville students didn't have access to.

[02:17:07] Like you were talking about, you know, equity of opportunity or access. We would have to have both local school boards partnered together to be able to do that. So they would have to fill out applications and then design a program together. But it's definitely something we can model.

[02:17:23] But we see those existing partnerships in regional CT centers and other programs. So I think that's something we can definitely pursue. Ms. McPherson. In terms of designing the plan, was it effective enough that students that excel well on the mastery-based learning?

[02:17:46] So let's just say I max out all my AP exams ahead of time, even before maybe they're given, you know, for really, really smart. Does that mean that I just get to go home or can I modify, I know, can I modify my plans so that I can go and do the internship?

[02:18:01] Does it allow some flexibility as you're advancing? Because obviously I would tell you I finished my exam, I'm ready to go home, let me go. But anyway. That's one of the challenges we're trying to solve right now. Yes. Ms. Hulton? My questions relate to next steps, so I don't know if Dr. Armstrong, if he's going to go back to his slides on next steps, that would help me.

[02:18:25] Certainly, and I did bring up the slide that responsive to your question earlier, Ms. Holton, about our data use and what we want to do moving forward is to take the data that we gain and collect through this experience to determine where students are demonstrating increases in growth and mastery, determine if this is affecting our teacher retention.

[02:18:44] I think that's a very interesting question to ponder is what would this do for teacher professionalism and their autonomy as well? Evaluate whether CTIMEFLEX increased three readiness outcomes and then take that and use it to create spotlights and models for other schools and use the data to support scale and spread of these models.

[02:19:03] And for the board, we will hope to have a formal first review of a formal definition of the notice form, as well as a best practices, guidelines, and data collection process for you all in February.

[02:19:24] Dr. Northern, just one more comment. I mean, I think the part of the definition that makes me most nervous is this project-based learning one. That's a phrase we've used a long time in education, and it gets kind of bandied about. And I think we definitely need to put some parameters around what it means to have a project-based learning assignment. I mean, because kids do that all the time. You know, you do a project and, you know. So anyway, I'm just concerned about that. Mastery-based, if we can get the assessments in place. The remote learning, I think we've got, you know, a pretty good idea of how that can be measured.

[02:20:00] alternative hours. We even have some mechanism to track that, and I can see the accountability there a little bit, but I think the project-based learning, at least in my mind, is the trickiest one to have an accountability measure in place, but you could be wrong about that. Ms. Hulton?

[02:20:19] As to that point, Virginia's been doing a lot of work over a number of years about project-based learning and assessment thereof. Am I right? Can you update us on that? I can't personally. We're We're right off the top, but we'd be happy to provide that to you at our next meeting. That might help address Dr. Northern's question when we come back to this.

[02:20:38] And then my next question is as to the process. Well, can you tell us what you've done already to engage stakeholders on this and what more is going to happen between now and February? Sure. I know, and Dr. Coons, please add in where I'm missing any pieces here.

[02:20:54] It was June, I believe, when we held listening sessions with VASSP and VAESP. We had a joint session where we— June and August. June and August, where we engaged them and provided them with legislation, got their feedback about what could this do for your division, what are the challenges you foresee, how could this benefit your schools.

[02:21:17] We did it in breakout rooms, and these smaller breakout rooms and focus groups got a lot of great feedback from that. we anticipate doing the same but expanding i was thinking about our workforce feedback group which includes some of our post-secondary representatives that was mentioned as well some of our workforce partners we've been working with them on career exploration acp work-based learning i think this would would dovetail nicely with that as well so we'll continue to engage other stakeholders moving forward we got a lot of input so we wanted to get input and ideas from some of our school leaders and our division leaders we've met with superintendents to get a sense of what they wanted to see that some of the challenges you saw in the deck our goal now is that we have

[02:21:57] directionality from the board some things you want to see but we want to like hit the field really well now because there's no vote tomorrow it's about taking this feedback now and getting extensive public feedback from that great it may have uh on that topic um am i right that what you're going to bring to well in february you're going to ask us is it going to be first and final review in february is that the idea is that the expectation and my understanding is it's first review, but I'm going to defer to Dr. Koons on that.

Well, that may help answer my next question, which is, so I'll go ahead if you don't mind, Dr. Koons. I see that you're going to ask formal

[02:22:35] approval of best practice and guidelines. So I'm right that there's a guidelines document that the legislation mandates, and we haven't yet seen a draft of that, right? Yeah, and I don't believe, I don't know if it's been mandated by the legislation, but we intend to provide that to school divisions, so best practice. Not big guidelines, but guidance. Well, I'm just looking at the statute, and it actually requires that we, I thought it required that we, by December 1st, update our guidelines for graduation requirements, essentially, on this topic,

[02:23:09] so, and also that we submit a report to the chair of the committees by November 1st, so I think we're already a little behind on the guidelines adoption, and I would just like to suggest that we get those documents out quickly so that the field can give us feedback in the event that you might be asking us to do final approval in february since we're essentially already behind on it but we ought to have not just this information you've given us today which is very helpful but we ought to have the actual guideline documents more than five days ahead of our february meeting so that

[02:23:45] you can get feedback from the field they're going to understand the details of this much better than we will and we'll want to be able to hear from them dr coons yeah thank you so much member hilton the seat time report was a progress report that was submitted um we'd be happy to take your advice and get guidelines to you early so that the report that was submitted by november due by november 1st went in yes ma'am great if we could get a copy of that i think it would help us too but but that the guideline update that was required by december 1st has not been done is that required is that accurate i'd have to go back and check the legislation

[02:24:22] that the board of ed shall by december 1st 2024 update its guidelines for graduation requirements as to local alternative pathways to standard units of credit alternatives to 140 clock hour, et cetera. So I think we'll have to go back and check because we did some guideline updating and that might've been part of it. The rest of it in quite detail specificity sure seems to be talking about what we're doing here. So all I'm saying is let's get it done, but let's get it done in a methodical fashion such that we all see a draft. We and the public and the stakeholders

[02:24:58] see a draft more than five days ahead of our February meeting so that we can if you're going to ask us for first and final review and if you're not going to ask us for first and final then there's a chance between first and final okay um thank you Dr. Armstrong um and I think if there's no other questions we will move to item C okay I'm still here yes great all right Madam President and board members I'm excited to provide you all with our high quality work-based learning

[02:25:37] definitions and experiences for your first review and discussion today. As you know, our work to strengthen our high-quality work-based learning model in the Commonwealth is not an isolated or new effort, just like the seed time flexibility we just discussed. Tomorrow, you'll be provided with the revised definition of career exploration and academic and career plan guidelines for your approval following my presentation in September. The career exploration definition, ACP guidelines, today's HQWBL definitions are all intended to support Virginia schools and students in their

[02:26:12] pursuit of sustainable career pathways and 3E readiness outcomes. We have engaged several key stakeholder groups across the Commonwealth as well as national experts to inform all of our 3E work to give school divisions meaningful concrete and practical support to guide students beginning in

elementary school to identify their personal interests, understand the meaning of work, connect their interests to course taking and post-secondary preparation and engage in meaningful work-based learning experiences to galvanize their pathway in order to graduate employed enlisted or enrolled in addition as you all know we are participating in the

[02:26:47] launch innovation impact cohort excuse me with other states who we are thought partnering with and one of the pillars of our framework is developing a system of high quality work-based learning, along with transitions and post-secondary credits and high-wage, high-demand credentials.

[02:27:04] The board has had several conversations about work-based learning, and we're, again, eager to start the discussion today with you all and continue to take this out into the field. As I mentioned earlier, we have our workforce feedback group, which has already met on several occasions and includes representatives from the workforce, local and state businesses and chambers, our post-secondary systems as well. And they have, even in October, we discussed some of the baseline thoughts around work-based learning with them and where they thought we needed to move forward.

[02:27:36] We have also provided that group with rubrics from other states who have already demonstrated success in this space. That includes Indiana, Ohio, and Tennessee. So this discussion is ongoing, and I'm excited to just get into this in more detail and get your feedback today from the board.

[02:27:55] Today I will briefly talk through the current high quality work-based learning definition and how that relates to our graduation requirements, which you'll see is going to be a distinct conversation between our graduation requirement work-based learning and then our 3E high quality work-based learning.

[02:28:14] We'll get into that in a moment. We'll talk about the justification for this new and unique definition for high quality 3E readiness work-based learning, which we are using the acronym HQ3EWBL. And then get into what that means in terms of the definition and the types of experiences that we feel will qualify as HQ3EWBL.

[02:28:37] And we'll end with some initial thoughts about how we'll evaluate those experiences for their inclusion on behalf of our students moving forward. The board has a responsibility per code to define high quality work-based learning for the purposes of graduation requirements.

[02:28:53] The current definition used for this purpose is that high-quality work-based learning are school-coordinated workplace experiences related to students' career goals and or interests, integrated with instruction related to the core technical competencies of the CTE course, and performed in partnership with local businesses.

[02:29:10] The VDOE currently identifies 12 CTE experiences as high-quality work-based learning. You can see these here. We have a good number of students, over 32,000 students, who take advantage of all of these different types of opportunities. We are not proposing a change to this definition or to the way we provide work-based learning credits for graduation requirements, but we are proposing that we add a new definition of high-quality work-based learning that will allow us to incentivize the options that provide the very best career experiences in support of our 3D

[02:29:44] framework for employment enlistment and enrollment essentially a different tier of hqwbl that will integrate into our model why is this important we know that for example i referenced our launch team identified areas of opportunity that can enhance the quality of our work-based learning one is to work to

ensure more consistent quality and rigor for students engaged in work-based learning across the state i know anecdotally as i i work with leaders from across the field in both cte and in school divisions that there are some divisions where they have created fairly robust work-based

[02:30:19] learning programs where students are having meaningful on-site apprenticeships internships that we know uh you know from the research and the data that is is more likely to lead to sustainable career pathways and then there are other divisions that uh students are it's exclusively a maybe a service learning model or job shadowing or it's just a mix of all so we want to work to incentivize the highest quality experiences that are going to best support that transition to enrollment, enlistment, or employment. Another area of need is access to the high-quality experiences, and we know that by tying a new definition and set of criteria for

[02:30:54] work-based learning to the 3E readiness framework, that should incent increased access through the creation of new opportunities for students that are aligned with rigorous expectations. Another challenge is recruiting businesses to participate. By defining the characteristics of high-quality 3E readiness work-based learning, the department will be able to communicate clearly the expectations for business owners, as well as a potential return on investment for participation in a work-based learning program. Increased quality and experience for students improves their skill sets, which creates a stronger employee pipeline for industries across the

[02:31:26] Commonwealth. Our goals in creating and connecting this new definition, a set of criteria to the 3D Readiness Framework, are to make sure that our students have consistently high-quality work-based learning experiences that allows them to seamlessly transition to post-secondary workforce and military service following graduation and aligned with our 3E readiness framework, which reflects and incentivizes work-based learning experiences that support those transitions. Schools will be able to establish and maintain strong business partner school relationships that provide students with high-quality work-based learning opportunities, and businesses, again, will see a return on their

[02:32:04] investment as WBL opportunities enhance the talent pipeline for them and support a thriving business community. But one thing that's not on here, it's a little less tangible, is that this really helps develop our relationships among our schools our businesses and our workforce and in the field when i've been out and talking with stakeholders about this a lot of times just lack of knowledge businesses say you know i want to do this for our schools and i'm not sure who to talk to and the schools say i'm not sure how to access our businesses and we know that different parts of the state have different key workforce demand businesses in their region so we know that this

[02:32:38] can help to galvanize those efforts across the state our proposed new definition for high quality 3e work-based learning is before you on this slide we will like to consider this to be an experience that is school coordinated within an industry or business partnership where sustained employment in a real world setting culminates coursework learning and accelerates a student's career goals supporting a seamless transition to employment enlistment and enrollment by providing students with substantive work over an extended period of time in high wage and in-demand industries aligned with students career plans as articulated in the academic career plan

[02:33:16] resulting in a nationally certified certificate of completion earning of an industry recognized credential and or post-secondary credit attainment and including mentoring and supervision by industry professionals that intentionally support students in building social capital with value in the labor market

and aids them in developing the skills and knowledge they need to successfully navigate the world of work i didn't want to read that verbatim just to underscore the importance of this and want to get your feedback as well on this definition as it will drive a lot of our work moving forward

[02:33:45] any comments or questions so far mr rotherham so like these definitions i mean they intuitively make sense but i mean my understanding is that across like i just recently gave a presentation and was um just enough to be dangerous about some other workforce data we're gathering so i saw this happening across the commonwealth is this all aligned with what's happening with what chev is doing what we're doing with the department of labor like what is are we sure sometimes in the past we've created silos because there's been good work happening but it hasn't been crosswalked

[02:34:23] like is this how does this fit into like the broader workforce strategy i want to just commend um dr armstrong for a minute as part of our launch team which is our statewide team where we meet with other states we are one of the few states that have higher ed sitting on that team we're also coordinating the secretary's office has several work groups where we coordinate regularly and then um andy i think you meet weekly with chev and the community college to really start to align this and align the thinking around this work so i think that's really important thank

[02:34:57] you in addition to that mr rotherham um you know i i work now to attend the virginia apprenticeship council meetings with miss overly from virginia works as well as representatives of the workforce agency so the short answer is yes it will be and even more importantly it has to be i think for our work based on your program to be meaningful it has to align with each of the different entities you just mentioned so we're definitely going to be pursuing that and have already that's great and i should have started by saying this is fantastic work and it's exciting and and like as i was learning about some of it that's happening elsewhere it's like the fact that we're

[02:35:34] starting to have like collect data focus on outcomes coordinate the stuff is is exciting and a lot of long-term dividends so i appreciate it thank you and what's really exciting is that i you're seeing different pieces of this machine we're building here across different presentations see time flexibility uh dr coons mentioned the work we're doing with the post-secondary organizations with HB 1087, College Career Ready Virginia Dual Enrollment. So, you know, along with several career exploration, ACP. So, everything is really syncing up really well right now. I think

[02:36:09] we have a great window in which to put all this together. Ms. Holton? Sorry. I'm sort of ducking the sun here best I can. On slide seven, I, this, the way I read this slide, it says one must meet all three of those qualifications in other words there's an and rather than an and or after the second one but the way i read the attachment it's and or and i think you mean and or we do yes ma'am in other words though if you the middle bullet is already part of our

[02:36:51] college and career readiness certificate so you don't mean to say that only if you get nationally certified uh credential can you meet the definition uh the high quality three e wbl definition you can meet it by meeting any of those three bullets yes i'm sorry i'm rereading the bold here but yeah that is correct um it doesn't mean that you have to satisfy every single one of those you have to be one of those but we're still again we're here to discuss this and really flesh out the details and how far we want to go with that but but that is the idea right now thank you

[02:37:26] Then my other question as to this slide is, and I do see this throughout both documents, reference to high wage as well as in-demand. And I get why we're focusing on in-demand careers.

[02:37:45] I worry about the focus on only high wage. And I'd just like to point out, for instance, that early childhood education and some of our health care fields are not high wage fields. and yet require some significant training, and we need people desperately, as we hear from Jenna Conway regularly when we're talking about our early childhood care. So, yes. No, they're not covered, unless Dr. Armstrong helps me understand, because these definitions say high wage and high

[02:38:19] demand. So, should that be and or also? So, if it was and or, I would be very happy. But as is, as written, if it's high wage and high demand, then I worry about the exclusion of folks learning to be early child, studying, frankly, to be elementary school teachers might not qualify as high demand, high wage.

[02:38:42] But certainly early childhood workers and a number of our healthcare fields would not qualify as high wage under the WIA, I can't, I can't pronounce it. Bowie. Bowie. I keep pronouncing Bowie as wea. Bowie. Thank you. Criteria. I don't think. So help me understand how we're going to accommodate that. Dr. Armstrong, why don't you explain the difference between high wage, high demand for the 3E readiness and then high wage, high demand for graduation? Sure. Dr. Myers, who I think was still here. Well, we worked extensively several months

[02:39:21] ago as we were developing our three indicators with VOE, the Virginia Office for Education Economics, excuse me, VOE maintains a very robust dashboard of regionally high-demand occupations using that data. We took that, and it's not verbatim from VOE, because again, this is a list that we developed and we applied some, again, like a family sustainable wage to of the the metrics that were involved in that but um we have taken our list of credentials that we have right now that the board approves each year and have assigned them high wage high demand or

[02:39:59] high wage or high demand so either both and or model across that now for the three framework as you know the the nature of or the the character of that credential determines the points you earn in the in the framework and so as we look at at work-based learning we're proposing essentially two definitions we still maintain that high quality work-based learning definition for graduation requirements this hq3 ewbl definition would we're proposing here today is designed to really incent careers and pathways to careers in in their region or across the state

[02:40:38] that are going to to be at least one or the other um and i know it's a roundabout way of explaining that but i think it's a discussion point um and just making sure we're clarifying all those details and we'll continue to get feedback about that so i think i heard you say you want so i understand there are two different work-based learning definitions there's one for graduation requirement and then there is a essentially more rigorous narrower category for hq3 ewbl is that accurate? That's correct. But I thought, and is the definition of high wage, high demand different

[02:41:14] for those two? No, no, that would not be different. And honestly, right now, the HQWBL definition as it currently exists doesn't reference high wage, high demand, or wage demand in their classifications. That's designed for this definition, which is associated with the 3A framework. So then I'm coming back, I'm not sure I'm clear on Ms. McPherson's, what we're talking about. Is it high wage and or high demand, or is it must be high wage and high demand jobs to qualify for H2-3-E-WB-L?

[02:41:48] And I will submit to the board that, again, this is all for conversation today. So that's something that we can definitely discuss. We haven't made a decision on that. We're going to get feedback about it, but I'd be happy to hear everyone's feedback. The way I read the documents is, there were some inconsistencies. Some places seemed to say and or, but I read them as saying and primarily. And so I

would encourage us to think about that and the potential. We do want to incentivize people to go into early childhood education. And if that's what HQ3EWBL is intended

[02:42:23] to do is incentivize folks into the careers where we need them to be trained and are in demand, then I would love us to be clear on that. Okay, I'm going to step back for just like five seconds here. I am really overwhelmed by this acronym.

[02:42:41] Yes, oh gosh. I mean, it's really giving me some anxiety. I really need us to go back to the drawing board on this. There's got to be something better. There's got to be something more succinct. There's got to be something that is, I mean, I'm just going to shut down after HQ.

[02:43:02] So I think we've got to rework this whole thing. That's the easiest fix we got here. We can take care of that. I do think, too, it's a lot of words that can also be quite a bit more succinct for clarity sake and for better understanding across these different silos that we're talking about here.

[02:43:34] And it has to be clearer, because if not, all y'all are going to do is field questions and calls on that. So I think that we've got to make sure we're crossing those boundaries and getting those things articulated very clearly here. That's just my initial feedback. I don't know if my other board members have any other feedback to that end. Dr. Northern? I'll agree with that.

[02:44:03] I think just a little bit more from me. I thought that the HQ3 thing was tight and solid, and I appreciated that definition. My semi-concern comes in sort of two systems. We've talked about we don't want bifurcated systems, and I get we've got a definition here for graduation, a definition for the more rigorous.

[02:44:30] I get that districts probably are getting a little squeamish if we just take the rug out under their feet with the graduation part. I'm wondering, though, if we can just transition gradually to one system where we just have the HQ3 and we say, you know, in two years or however much time, we're going to give you, but sooner or later, it's all going to be on the HQ3 and we're not going to do it tomorrow. Because as I look at your table in the attachment, when you've got learning about work, learning through work, and learning for work, it's really nice, right? And I actually think that you

[02:45:07] can put both systems in the same chart so it doesn't look so bifurcated. And in my mind, job shadowing, service learning, mentoring is all stuff that could happen in middle school exploration. You know how we have CTE middle school exploration? Yeah, that would be, maybe that's becomes you know the middle i mean the first um column which is the elementary middle i don't know what the second column becomes with those other examples and then the third column for the most part seems to me to be your new definition right um so anyway i'm just trying to you know and then maybe if it's a table like that and they see both systems together and then this

[02:45:45] is sort of what we're transitioning to because the the h the high school graduation requirements aren't going to go away. They're just going to be pushed down, right, to a lower level where it's more appropriate in the middle school for them to have these experiences. By the time you get to high school, you should be doing these more rigorous activities. So that's my two cents.

[02:46:06] Thank you. And Dr. Northern and to Madam President's comments as well, I think taking this and maybe making it less words and more visualizations perhaps will make this more crisp for you all February and rethinking our acronyms. Not only that, I do think that to Dr. Northern's point, we need to

really focus on the rigor of our work-based learning experiences in high school and take things that are less rigorous, like in many cases, the job shadowing and the service

[02:46:39] learning. That can all be part of exploration in middle school. We are trying to put more of the emphasis on that exploration in middle school to give that real time and opportunity for those credentialing programs and other such programs, apprenticeships in the high school years.

[02:47:01] So I think that actually fits best sort of in those two main buckets there. So the less rigorous in the middle school timeframe and the more rigorous, more credentialing apprenticeships in high school. Ms. Holton? Yeah, so I completely agree with not only the acronym. I mean, it can be a nickname. It doesn't have to be an acronym. I'm trying so hard to get the VQB one, the early childhood one. So, and I also agree, concur with Dr. Northern and others' concern about really

[02:47:37] having double definitions of work-based learning does not support transparency for parents and stakeholders and so i think our goal ought to be a single definition of work-based learning if you make if you make it clear that on both the high wage high demand issue and the element the ways to meet work-based learning if you make it clear on both of those that it is and or rather than and then i don't think the definitions are that far apart and that maybe we can decree that

[02:48:11] the new definition uh will be the definition for graduation purposes as well as um uh uh incentive the red the accountability framework but with a little delayed implementation because we don't want to change graduation requirements for current you know students who've completed what they thought was their work-based learning requirement under the old scheme ought to be grandfathered in in some sense and we've done that on changes we've we've implemented in the past so implement the new definition but grandfather in current high school students that gives the divisions time to

[02:48:49] accommodate thank you and i'm sorry and i'm probably getting ahead of the game and i'm sure you've already got a plan i'm sitting here thinking about school systems and superintendents and different people in the school board office of each system who's going to coordinate who's going i know you have this plan but who monitors who keeps up with all this you know what i'm saying the capacity of school staff too right specific coordinator and those optional right now but like

[02:49:28] this is why i'm all for it i can imagine wow what a task it would be to and there you're right there are divisions now that have dedicated work-based learning coordinators others that do not probably have that's what i'm also and again not being a debbie downer because i'm all for it but this is what we need to hear problem you know like who's going to madam president job i would think if if a school system really embraces it and takes it on board from the job shadowing middle school level to you know right absolutely but i just i know you've already thought of all this i'm just asking

[02:50:06] appreciate it miss holton uh to miss kilgore's point i totally agree and in the we have had discussions in the past about including a work-based learning coordinator in our standards of quality so that the state is helping fund those positions and we the board has not yet adopted that as part of our soqs and the general assembly has not funded but i do think that to do divisions that are doing this right are locally funding uh you know

[02:50:43] somebody to be the liaison to the business community and you just can't do it without them um i did have that leads into one more question which is one of the divisions that's doing this right already and and using their their local funding to do it at hampton uh dr coons made reference to the hampton

academies one of the uh and so those of you who haven't had a chance to visit hampton i strongly encourage it they're happy to do um take visitors and they're they're are really doing it division-wide, everybody in high school is in a pathway. And some of those

[02:51:19] pathways include law enforcement and firefighter, et cetera. And I just see a lot of references here to industry and business. And I would just ask that in the final documentation, we clarify that that language includes local government. So it's government, nonprofit sector should be included in the definition. It's not just private sector industry and business that we're interested in supporting. Right. Thank you. Have we cut you off? Slightly, but that's okay. Sorry. I just did want

[02:51:56] to mention to your point, Madam President, is that what we propose to be included in the, I want to use a different term now, the enhanced next tier of work-based learning are these four experiences, apprenticeship, clinical experience, internship, and reimagined school-based enterprise. So we're taking the 12 current experiences and condensing them to four for the purpose of our increased rigor work-based learning. And you did mention that earlier. And I will say too, to Dr. Northern's comment, is a lot of the reasoning behind, at least for now, establishing

[02:52:34] these two definitions is a nod to concern the field. Because again, they are midway through the year, graduation requirements, it's a much bigger conversation. But I do agree we can take this and put it all under the umbrella of one definition. Are divisions going to understand what a reimagined school-based enterprise is? I mean, I don't, but that may be some nomenclature that everybody knows but me, but what is that? So, for example, at the school where I

[02:53:09] serve as principal, we had a bank branch inside the school, and the students were manning as tellers in the bank branch, and it was associated with coursework they were taking in finance, and so there are schools that have some type of established enterprise for students within the building this is one though I think of all those of those four experiences that will require probably the most education the school divisions because that happens in pockets but I think it is a valuable experience however we would need to extend some more education that president it's all time Dr. Armstrong am I right on this one you do propose to bring it back to us for final

[02:53:49] approval in february this is first review and you're going to be asking for final in february this is first review we intend to take your feedback today gather more feedback from the field as well using what we've gathered today and then come back to you all for final review in february so again as with my request on the prior topic if you could get the documentation out the actual document i know we have a draft here but the next iteration out to the field because there are some frankly technical errors in the draft some of those and ors and there's some other technical inconsistencies in the draft and that field will help you they will fly speck it for

[02:54:28] you yes they will if you give them time and opportunity certainly and madam president the last slide is the the next iteration of this work once we establish a definition and agree on which experiences will qualify in this higher tier of rigor work-based learning we will develop a rubric to evaluate these experiences as well and we intend to use the following criteria to evaluate that meaningful and job placement accelerated learning options as well as career navigation supports with

[02:55:07] a lot which aligns with the definition you saw earlier but we'll need to to really work to establish that definition and those experiences first before we go into too much detail on the

[02:55:16] rubric and I think. Yes, that's it. Thank you. Okay, Mr. Gilstrat, item D. Good afternoon, President Creasy, Dr. Coons and members of the board. I bring to you today a discussion topic, something that is a opportunity for us going forward. I think most of you have heard of nationally board certified teachers and there are incentive awards that we have done for years. We've had some changes coming out of this last budgetary season and legislative

[02:56:02] season that we need to look at and prepare for. There's some changes that we'll need to make to our guidance documents based on General Assembly adjustments to the budget code, and so that's what I'm here to talk about. Just a little background of the fund first, and then some discussion of changes in the code, budget language, and then implications. For the background, as I mentioned, National Board Certified Teacher, it's been going along for quite some time in Virginia and across the nation. The last time we had any guidance changes from the board was 2012. So we've

[02:56:41] been under the same guidance document from the board for over 13 years. And so there's some changes that need to happen in that just based on the change in the budgetary language. The 2012 guidance document has some very specific criteria and expectations that will have to be adjusted.

[02:57:02] But let me go on to the code for a second so we can get to the code. So in this last General Assembly session, there were no changes made in the code, but I want to point out a couple things in the code that will definitely need to be considered.

[02:57:20] One, as you see on that second bullet, it refers to public school teachers that obtain the National Board Certification. It does not reference any other group. It will in the budget language when I get to that. So though the General Assembly had an opportunity to change the code possibly, they did not change the code but they did change the budget language but it does impact us when we make our awards and when we adjust our guidance language it also refers up there to a non reverting fund so the funds that we have year to year do build possibly if we don't spend them all and have an interest so there is a

[02:57:56] possibility that one of the opportunities that we have going forward will not be necessary but we will be providing that information to you before We're at the February board meeting so that you can make an informed decision on what we might do, and I will get to what I mean by that.

[02:58:11] So in the previous budget language, this is what it said. It only had this brief amount of language that went with the old language, and it still talked about $5,000 for initial nationally board-certified teachers and $2,500 for each year thereafter.

[02:58:33] The part in bold is something I definitely want to point out. It says the board shall establish procedures for determining amounts of awards if the money and the fund are not sufficient to award each eligible teacher the appropriate award amount. And that is a potential going forward, maybe not this year, but in the future years, because of the broadening definition of what the who and what classification can receive the money.

[02:58:57] It does talk about that you can issue guidance, which you have in the past. All right. Prior to this year, the references were classroom teachers, and it also had an amount for $5,035,000 for the first year and the same for the second year.

[02:59:19] That has been changed with our new budget language, but more than just the amount, also some of the definitions and some included groups. now we have the current budget language and it does in the first group still include classroom teachers but it also enters in grants for candidates working so

there would be funding through the budget that we would provide for those that were attempting to become nationally board certified or if they were renewing in what we call the maintenance of certification

[02:59:54] moc so that money was not in the previous budget language and as you can see up there the amount that was allocated is less it's 37 500 less than in the previous budget languages and so we have a broader category but a little bit less money it does continue on in the budget language beyond that first paragraph that we had before and it adds a fairly large possible group here it says any public school staff member so in the past if you were a nationally board certified teacher

[03:00:31] and you went on to be an assistant principal you forfeited your nationally board and you were not able to receive those funds anymore if you were changed from a teacher to a counselor same situation if you went on to administration at a central office within a school division you would forfeit your national board certification bonuses but through this additional language all those people that i just referenced would also be eligible for the national board funding so we're we're talking principals, counselors, division staff, and we do not have a clear record of how

[03:01:06] many of those there are because every year when the numbers are submitted, those are omitted from those numbers. So that could potentially raise the amount. We also have what I referred to earlier as the any candidate category, and this would be those who are attempting for the first time to become nationally board certified, or if they let their nationally board certification end and they had to go back and renew it. There's costs that associated with that and according to the budget language half those costs would be paid on the front end and then half would be paid on the back

[03:01:42] end. We do not collect that kind of data in the past because we don't have a direct feed with National Labor Board. They don't let us know who started the assessments and since there was no funding for that the teachers weren't generally reporting that to their school divisions. So that is one opportunity for change going forward as well. I already mentioned this. It's mentioned twice within there, the candidate reference and the maintenance of certification. And then we have, then we also have the date in which divisions would provide us that information. Divisions

[03:02:21] would not be able to have provided us that information this year due to the mechanisms in place to record that information. We do not have that kind of platform designed yet for receiving the information as people are entering the program. Only divisions would only provide us that information on the back side and annually verify themselves. So talk about implications. First implication, the decrease in funding through the new budget. It allows for there to be some teachers that would receive the funding.

[03:02:57] And then once we used up any money we had carried over from our non-reverting funds, we would have to make decisions as a board on what we were going to do next. The board's current guidelines also would need to be updated because in our current guidelines, it refers to any public school staff member in the budget language, but it only refers to teachers.

[03:03:16] In our guidance, it also gives a definition for teachers, and they had to work at least 50% in the classroom. and it specifically excluded administrators from in central office because they were not eligible prior to this budgetary season. There's also a reference to a five-year license in our current language which hasn't been updated to our now 10-year licenses that we currently have. That's a fairly minor change but that would be a change that we would need nonetheless. I've mentioned this already but we do not have the database capacity to collect those that are entering into

[03:03:56] the system and there's not a way for us to track the title one references in the new budget language that is all normally handled by the divisions as they report it out to us they verify it on their side which is what the last slide the last bullet point there is in case you were curious about how much some of these things cost we've got the initial cost up there for somebody who's getting their national board certification and then the maintenance cost as they are trying to add or extend their time, these would be costs that we would potentially be paying out out of the same

[03:04:32] fund, which we currently do not. Past year expenditures, so you can see in some years we went over the $5,035,000, some years we did not. So this may not be an issue for us this year, and so there may not be a solution needed for that, but there could be. Once we receive all the data back from the divisions, we'll have a better understanding of how much money we're talking and with that amount of money we'll come to you with February in February to let you know yes we have enough money to meet this full requirement or no we do not have enough money

[03:05:09] and we would need to see what the guidance from the board would want us to do regardless of whether or not we have money this year or not it would probably be a good idea to put that guidance or those recommendations into our guidance document so that at any time in the future we could just go to our regular scheduled, you know, plan within the guidance document and go and follow those guidance steps. I created a couple board options, but I just did those so you could kind of get a feel for what that would look like. These may not be necessary at all because if we have enough funding, we do not have to do that this year, but those would be things that you could consider

[03:05:49] going forward with the guidance for the guidance document coming out in February. I just gave a bit of an explanation which you're welcome to have read or read yourself it's not not necessarily something you'd have to go with this is the timeline we're currently working under we're right now with board input and plans we've already started the collection window that was started about a month ago we do have a second tier of that because the initial collection would be more like our normal collection like we did with just teachers but when we're looking at also those

[03:06:25] who are candidates we have to do that a different way because there's not a way for the divisions to report that in the same method so that should go out this week and so we should have data we think we'll have all the data we'll need well before the february deadline any discussion or questions questions for mr gilstra thank you thank you mr gilstra up the uh uh you and i spoke briefly earlier and i asked about uh told you i was going to ask you about the non-reverting surplus so as

[03:07:01] As I see it, in 2023-2024, we underspent the budget by $600,000 and the prior year by several hundred thousand. Correct.

[03:07:17] Do we know, so is there an accumulated surplus from those two years? The state treasurer, they're the ones that maintain that, and they have not given us a number for that yet. there's an interest that changes on a daily basis with that kind of large amount, but that'll come out once we have the amount that we'll be requesting. Normally, we only know what we were budgeted, and then we go ahead and submit the full, like in the years that we went over, we submitted the full bill, and they paid the bill based on what we had carried over. We will be endeavoring to try to find out how much room we have. So just looking at those annual appropriations for the

[03:07:52] last two years and the expenditures for the last two years, my rough math says we have almost, might have almost a million dollars quite possible that we could have that amount we do not know how

much we're going to have in extended debt though coming out of the broad so as to that i'm looking there's two ways the new changes potentially increases the expenditure one is accommodating the uh applicants the those who are in the process of getting national board and that's something around 108 a year right that the number of people pursuing it was 108 last year uh just doing the

[03:08:31] math that might add a hundred thousand dollars maybe a couple hundred thousand dollars if you add in the uh those who are doing the renewals etc but well within the we would still be well within the current appropriation without even dipping into the surplus so uh am i right about that mostly let me let me just correct one thing the the number you were reciting on how many people get it each year is not the same as the number of people attempting each year so we would be paying on the front side for those attempting whether or not they completed it or not we pay

[03:09:06] half of it so yes within within it probably isn't a drastic difference in the amount but there could be a difference there i think the bigger difference could come from the other number than this so so my guess and i'm purely speculating here but that the general assembly was contemplating that in that 600 000 or so underspent uh uh appropriation from final private previous years there was enough money to accommodate the uh those attempting to achieve national board certification the bigger problem is what you've helpfully identified as potentially broadening

[03:09:46] the uh availability of the bonus to administrators counselors etc non-classroom teachers and i just i have a comment and a question on that and my comment is i wonder if that uh change was intentional or not and just looking at the budget language that you cite on page 10 f1 it is the intent of the general assembly that the department of education provide bonuses from state funds to classroom teachers so in one place in the budget language it appears to continue to limit the

[03:10:23] availability of these bonuses to classroom teachers as the statute does and of course we all know that appropriations language overrides the statute but where one part of the appropriation language seems to say classroom teachers and another part of the appropriation language seems to broaden the definition i wonder if there's any way we could inquire or find out and maybe this is a perspective but to frankly talk to the appropriations committee staff as i know you all do regularly to figure out was that an intentional change or not and if it wasn't an intentional change

[03:10:57] then uh my question would be could an alternative you bring us in february be that we put uh non classroom teachers on a lower priority so that we fully fund classroom teachers and fully fund applicants, those in the process of getting board certification, and not fund those who aren't classroom teachers unless and until those two categories. So in other words, I'm asking, would that third option be worth considering? I think that's exactly why Mr. Gilstrap and the department it's bringing this to us is because we do want that. We do need this discussion to happen. We

[03:11:37] want to create, um, as much consensus as possible within the board to say, look, we're, we want to prioritize. And I think Ms. Holton, us at least having this discussion is helpful because there is that ability to have you bring out, you know, the piece about, well, there's the classroom and we can talk to appropriation staff, but ultimately it does kind of rest with how we want to prioritize. And that may be the way we end up prioritizing is, okay, look, the intent has always been to support, historically, has always been to support those classroom teachers that are

[03:12:16] directly impacting instruction who are nationally board certified. And then let's move down the prioritization when it comes to whether or not we are flushed with cash to be able to support it or not,

but I do think that that is certainly, I mean, that was my thought process was to support those classroom teachers prior to sort of moving down the list, right? And I would just say that so you've presented us two options, as you say, just to get the conversation started, but reduction of all funds awarded, I would really encourage us to make that a last resort. We don't

[03:12:55] want people making less money than they did last year. That is a terrible solution. And frankly, I think the first come first serve means nobody knows what they're getting. That's also a terrible solution. So I would propose and ask that you bring us back this third option that would honor the General Assembly's clear intent as to applicants, but also honor the statutory preference for classroom teachers. And my back of the envelope math, which is worth precisely

[03:13:34] nothing, would suggest that we have plenty of money to do that if we don't go beyond the classroom teachers. And especially if I'm right that we've filled up a million dollar surplus in this account. I think that's a strong option for us to move towards and, you know, exactly the purpose for this discussion. Mr. Rotherham, do you have a comment? I agree. I agree on prioritizing classroom teachers i have a more general question it it's we are giving preference to title one in terms of applicants but we're not giving preference to high poverty schools kind of in any other way

[03:14:08] in this do we have any flexibility as we consider this because this does seem somewhat disconnected from we're concerned about high poverty schools we want more resources there we're concerned about teacher shortages and then we're sort of spreading this around um i certainly agree with miss holton we shouldn't do anything that causes somebody to have a reduction but it seems like going forward we could are there how much flexibility do we have to potentially start to align this more with making sure high poverty shortage subject areas you know shortage geography areas of parts of the state that have a harder time than others do we do we have any flexibility

[03:14:48] there under the language i would defer that final answer but i would say what i pointed out at the very beginning and how broad the code was where the code said it is the board's responsibility to decide how to do that so i would say that it does grant some flexibility there i'll also say that there's only one section really that addresses the title one and that's with the the new candidates it's not with the current teachers and maybe the theory there is if you're working in a high poverty school give you a bonus for doing that i don't know but there's got to be a reason

[03:15:21] that we were not given within the budget language well i think the data we've been shown previously suggests that not surprisingly high poverty schools have fewer national board certified teachers than wealthier schools and so clearly the general assembly i would think the intent is to help address that redress provide some redress for that imbalance teacher recruitment and retention strategy right i agree and i like that i'm asking could we do more so could we do differentiated bonuses so you get more as a national board teacher in based on some criteria

[03:16:00] high poverty geography i need like do we have the flexibility to potentially i think that would probably be something that you would have to get back to the drawing board i mean i don't know that that's something that we can you know iterate on the fly right here i do think that we need to figure out like is there a means by which and you know perhaps there's there further opportunities to to certainly um you know raise those particular issues because i don't disagree that that that's a it's a need yeah i'm not asking you to do it on the fly but if it's a work session or start to see some potentially some options on that because this does this does seem misaligned from our

[03:16:40] general for us yeah mr hanson i would even suggest going back to the conversation two hours ago on our schools that are in need of intensive support or off track this is where we talked about dedicating resources to those this would be a perfect place to start i i would just say that i think that would require unless we're if we're in the unfortunate position of having to cut such that teachers who are currently receiving those bonuses don't get what they've been getting in the past, then we could certainly use that criteria where you're, are you serving in a high need school

[03:17:18] as a criteria because we are authorized to award less than the full award. But I don't think the statutory or budget language allow us to go, current language allow us to go over the 5,000 and the $2,500 or the costs for the applicants.

[03:17:37] So if we wanted to go over, that would, for instance, be something that the governor or the legislature could propose to increase beyond the $5,000 for teachers willing to go to our high-need schools. And you'll have a much better vision of what this really looks like when we have all that data on how many teachers we have and how much it impacts all the money.

[03:18:00] so in February you'll that's one of the reasons why we wanted to have this so you could have this discussion and get the thought it's already going. However if we do want to come back with some more options I think we just need to be clear that we may not be able to pay out stipends until after board action in February. When do we usually pay them out? It's usually right after the new year so where we'd be about a month behind. Well we don't meet until late February so teachers who are used to getting their bonus in early January or not going to get it until early March now?

[03:18:32] That's quite possible, yes. Well, how can we help address that? Can we authorize you today to do award the narrower category? You know, in other words, if we give you discretion in certain categories, because I hate to see people losing something they've had.

[03:18:52] That would be a, again. Why don't we just, it would have to be an action taken tomorrow in our business meeting. We could just say the board will release the classroom teacher funds today, and then additional categorization will be worked on and decided in February.

[03:19:14] If we buy consensus, add an agenda item tomorrow to authorize really three tiers to do the traditional classroom teachers 5,000 and 2,500 as a first tier. If funds permit as of January 1st, you can go ahead and push that out the door without waiting for further authorization from us.

[03:19:35] And number two, if funds permit, including taking advantage of any surplus from prior years to pay out the folks who are in the process of earning their certification, and then not to authorize anything beyond that until you come back to us, maybe that's the way to do it.

[03:19:55] It's a terrible shame to have people expect they're getting something that they've gotten in every prior year. Yeah, especially, you know, given the legislature's intent was clearly to expand, not to contract. Yeah. Okay. Anything else on this item? We'll get the team working on a new issue with this.

[03:20:19] I would love for us, though, especially if there's going to be additional funds to also start to think about what are some options where we could prioritize, again, areas and not just spread this like peanut butter. but to the extent we have new money targeted at areas that we i think collectively the board is concerned about and we may need to look to determine whether or not the policy is allowed uh mr hanson i would even suggest a little caution in terms of additional funds i think that there may be other vehicles and better vehicles to incentivize and reward teachers in this program

[03:20:53] so i i just want to be a little cautious that we're trying to build upon something here that I think there might be better venues to really recognize teachers yeah because let's not forget not every excellent teacher has has a national board certification so um all right thank you appreciate it all right we're going to take a quick like three minute break before we start

[03:21:19] our next presentation give our learning heroes team a chance to get everything up and ready

[03:25:29] We are on item E now, and we would like to continue our national expert series today with

[03:31:43] Learning Heroes. And I would like to introduce our two speakers. Bibb Hubbard is the founder and president of Learning Heroes, the leading research nonprofit studying parent mindsets in the U.S. as it relates to their child's education.

[03:32:00] Bibb came to this work having served the Clinton administration, both at the Labor Department and in the White House. She found her love for education and specifically family engagement working for the CEO of Scholastic before leading Governor Napolitano's post-secondary initiative as the chair of the National Governors Association.

[03:32:21] Immediately prior to founding Learning Heroes 10 years ago, Bibb was in leadership at the Gates Foundation focused on both K-12 and higher ed. It was in this role that she was inspired to create a nonprofit solely focused on parents. She is a Virginia native and the proud mom of two boys who attend Alexandria City Public Schools.

[03:32:43] Cindy Williams is the co-founder of Learning Heroes and the CEO of Waypoint Education Partners. She served in the George W. Bush administration both in the White House during NCLB and then leading communications for the U.S. Department of Education. Prior to working in the White House, She served in leadership on Capitol Hill, worked alongside Richard Worthland worldwide as the chief of staff to Elizabeth Dole.

[03:33:12] She and Bibb met working at the Gates Foundation in communications and advocacy roles. Cindy recently served as chair of the Washington State Charter Commission. During her time, 20 years as a Virginia resident, her oldest son was the grateful recipient of an excellent early intervention program at Arlington Public Schools.

[03:33:31] So welcome to both of you. And we are so thankful for you being here today to present to us. Thank you so much. Thank you all for having us. And I want to especially thank Dr. Kuhn for your incredible partnership in addressing the important role that families play in advancing both student and school success.

[03:33:51] So thank you so much. And we also want to acknowledge Secretary Gadara in inviting us to be able to present to you today. I know she's not here, but we're also grateful for her partnership as well. So let's get started. For those of you who may not be familiar with Learning Heroes, as President said, we're 10 years old, and our mission is pretty simple, to strengthen the relationship between homes and schools to advance student learning and well-being.

[03:34:23] And we do our work, there we go, in deep partnership. Everything we do has a collective action orientation. So this is just a few of our incredible partners who we are super humbled to have on this slide. We work across the education ecosystem to be able to touch down through the multiple dimensions that

families touch down across education. They sit at the center. So we have this opportunity to work collaboratively in many different ways.

[03:34:56] And everything we do is anchored in research. So you're going to hear a lot about this this afternoon. We have over our 10 years conducted, we're now at more than 20 national surveys, deep, deep qualitative sessions across the country. Most of our research is conducted in both English and Spanish.

[03:35:20] We focus on low-income families, families of color, and we also survey teachers, principals, guidance counselors, students, and it informs everything that we do. We are very evidence-based. So with that, I'm going to talk a little bit about just sort of parent context, some parent mindsets that I think are important to set the stage and go a little bit deeper.

[03:35:46] So literally in 2016, we revealed this data point, nine out of 10 parents, regardless of race, income, and education level, believe their child's at or above grade level in reading and math.

[03:36:02] And I'm sad to report that as of this summer, it is still nine out of 10 parents, regardless of race, income, or education level, believe their child is at or above grade level in reading and math. Because as of all of you know, we do not have 9 out of 10 students who are performing at grade level in reading and math.

[03:36:22] And so for us, this was a clarion call in 2016 to understand why. Why is this perception there? And there are many reasons, but the primary reason is because, you know, almost 80% of parents report that their children are bringing home all Bs or above.

[03:36:43] and for a parent that good grade equals grade level mastery. So if you have a fourth grade parent whose child in reading is bringing home A's or B's, that fourth grade parent automatically assumes, hey, my fourth grader is reading at a fourth grade level because they're getting all A's or B's. We don't typically let parents know that that's not what that means. That means that that child is turning in their homework. They're asking good questions. They're working really hard. They are performing well for their grade level of reading, which could be a first, second, or third

[03:37:18] grade level reading. And so there is sort of this thing that happens where grades are masking for parents what's really happening with their students' achievement. So I'm going to turn this over to Cindy to talk a little bit about what keeps parents up at night. And this is important as you think about that 90% stat. Sure. So we call this a worry battery. It's something we've been doing really for the last 10 years. Gallup partnered with us most recently, and they were blown away by what we found. So you assume that academics are going to be on this list. But as

[03:37:55] you guys can see, you know, your child's math skills and your child's reading skills are at the very bottom. So we start with impact of social media on your child, your child experiencing stress for anxiety emotional well-being then getting to paying the bills so you know as parents we worry like that's just part of our job but isn't it interesting the things that they worry about before it's actually paying the bills but you know your assumption going into this this exercise is usually that the math and the reading skills are going to rank higher but the purpose of learning heroes really is to flip this grid so what happens when a parent knows that their child

[03:38:31] isn't on grade level is that the worry battery actually flips they worry differently so when you look at this once you say to a parent you are a parent whose child is below grade level in math and then you ask them to go back to that worry and stack rank it again you'll see that math skills interestingly even

much more so than reading end up at the very top of that list then you go to impact of social media on your child your child be on track with the academic expectations for their grade bumps way up your child gaining the knowledge and skills needed to be ready for college

[03:39:05] bumps way up so um so i just i would say that part of this this demand side of the equation that you're trying to create i don't know about you guys but when we were at the gates foundation we kept feeling like we're just pushing the boulder uphill like why are people not screaming in the streets why are they not furious that their child isn't getting their reading and the math instruction that they deserve or that their school is not performing better.

[03:39:31] And at the end of the day, it's because they're not worried until we ask them to be worried, until we give them super straight up information that is clear and easy to understand that says your child is behind. But once you do, parents worry is like this really powerful force that we're just not capturing.

[03:39:50] They will worry differently and then they will make very different decisions about their child's time and about the options that they have in front of them and so we have a lot more that we've learned about that but you know it's hard to understand learning heroes without knowing that sort of our north star is this nine out of ten and our hope is really in this concept that we're leaving parents and all that they can bring to the table on the field and then if we can tell them the truth they can actually worry differently so that's our aha this is our many slides yeah and just to sort of uh bring this to life and this is a really difficult

[03:40:24] slide to read so apologies but the key takeaway is we asked okay so for the parents who know that their child is below grade level in math we saw that they worry differently so how do they what actions are they taking are they taking different actions as they're engaging with their teachers and the answer is yes so when all parents are talking to their child's teachers right thankfully you can see you know 88 percent of all parents are asking getting a general update on their child's progress but if you when you start to scrutinize this list of actions very specifically those who

[03:41:03] know that their child's not performing in math are asking more academic related questions they're partnering with their teacher in slightly different ways how can you know should i be concerned you know the subjects that my child is doing well in what are you are you concerned about my child's academic progress. So they're asking more specific questions around their child's academics, which is part of our goal. How do we get parents and teachers to partner up around helping students succeed? And not just asking, which is typically, given the structure that teachers are provided and

[03:41:40] parents are provided around the parent-teacher conference, you have 10 to 15 minutes, if you're lucky to find out how your child is doing. So you get the basic question of, "How's my child?" The teacher says, "Oh, your child is great." All of these important things, but you don't really get a chance to dig in necessarily on the academic piece because parents don't even know to ask the question because their child is getting a B and they think they're okay. And when we ask teachers, they also aren't trained to engage with families and we'll show that slide in just a moment.

[03:42:13] back to cindy so when we first started this work we encountered a fair amount of bias and we've done work across across the u.s not deeply in all 50 states but certainly deeply in 25 of them and so i guess we just always feel like it's really important to say that black parents care the most about knowing if their child is below grade level and then second to that is hispanic parents and then white parents and so

we know this this data is hard to communicate and teachers say it's really hard and we acknowledge that but we also feel like it's worth it to do the work

[03:42:52] particularly given the parents who are asking for it the most oh this is my favorite slide we'll jump in here too so um so basically parents have something they think they know right my kid is fine um i feel great about my child you know my child's got an a in english and a b in math and she's an excellent student and so when your job is okay how do we push up against that thing that the parent believes they actually know and you want in a best case scenario for parents to self-realize oh wait a minute that's not true and so the way you can do that

[03:43:31] is with two contradictory pieces of information. So the way we like to say this is two contradictory pieces of information help parents rethink that thing they thought they knew. And so that's why the SOL is so important, but more importantly communicating it effectively is so important because it becomes one of the things. So parents are pretty agnostic about the two pieces of contradictory information it can be map it can be growth data it can be sol it can be your school accountability rating but if you can give them two things that are really different than that a and b

[03:44:11] they'll start to flip and so uh as you can see here the numbers are pretty dramatic and in a polling situation that's almost unheard of which is why we kept having to do it over and over again to sort of double check ourselves but to me this is the most hopeful piece of information we can bring you today is you guys are doing such an amazing job of putting so much data out there in front of parents over the next couple of years and if it is clearly communicated to parents with a lot of context you'll start to flip them they'll have their own aha moment that oh my gosh i need to be

[03:44:45] be doing things differently. My kid's not where I thought they were. And as we dig in further, the teacher side of this also is an important part of the picture. So we know grades can be misleading. And we know that parents can do the math. They are very responsive to different forms of data in terms of understanding where their child is. And another, you know, we have so much data that we can't share, but one of the other questions that we asked in a national survey,

[03:45:22] 89% of parents, one of the most important things for them to get from their school's communications from their schools is knowing how their child is achieving. Like, it's essential for me to know where my kid is, even if it's not good news. Like, parents obviously can handle it.

[03:45:40] They want to know and teachers want to tell them. So the how is the really hard part. So you can see here, we ask teachers, you know, how easy is it to do these to have different kinds of conversations with families. And many say it is not easy to communicate difficult information to families. We know that it is fear based. We also have quantitative data from teachers that say, I'm afraid I'm not going to be believed.

[03:46:09] and I'm afraid I'm going to be blamed. And it's not an expectation for me to unpack this data with families. So school leaders play an essential role in setting the conditions, creating the policies, the practices, giving teachers the time, the tools, the support to be able to engage with families. This is not easy work building relationships, but it does pay dividends and it is happening across the country in many ways. And we're again, just humbled and excited to be able to partner with Virginia and the data that you're providing

[03:46:44] to families and supporting teachers to be able to then engage with families around helping support students succeed. So just sort of shifting gears a bit, one of our strategies to address the data that you've just seen, you know, parents may not have a complete and holistic understanding of how their child is progressing. Teachers may be struggling with how to tell and share different kinds of data with families. So we decided to launch what we call Go Beyond Grades, a parent

[03:47:16] action and awareness campaign. We launched it in the spring of 2023 in six different cities, and then we went back in 2024 and we launched it here in Tarrant County in Texas and again in New York City. And what we did was we took two data points. You can see the 96% of Tarrant County parents think their child reads at grade level. We did that research. And per the Star report, which is the Texas SOL, 52% of students in Tarrant County are reading at grade level.

[03:47:50] And we did these billboards in New York City, Washington, D.C., Boston, Sacramento, Houston, all across the country. And what we found was super exciting. And when we did post evaluation of this campaign among parents the parents who remembered seeing this billboard and again parents can do the math they see the data were twice as likely to take actions that we we support which is talking to your teacher at the end of the school year how did my child do what should i do this summer to help support them they were twice as likely to enroll their child

[03:48:29] in summer learning so they took the actions twice as likely if they saw this billboard and other social media and importantly and along the lines why we think it was so successful is as part of the broader campaign in addition to the power of the data it's the power of storytelling so we lifted up parent stories around this part the power of partnering with teachers so we're just going to show a quick video of sharita jones and her daughter christiana as a as just a one small way that we are lifting up different parent voices, which we think is a huge contributor to the

[03:49:09] success of these local campaigns. Someone's going to help us play the video. Thank you. What's the first thing that I say? What's the first thing that I have that turns two words into one word? Sherita Jones is a hands-on mom. She felt her daughter Christiana was doing well in her last school, especially after all the time away from the classroom during the pandemic.

[03:49:41] christiana was a great student in class not a behavior problem at all i thought that she was doing great from the last report card but when her daughter christiana moved to a new school she learned her good report cards had not been telling the full story it was extremely surprising to find out that she was on a lower reading level than what i thought she was the new school's assessments showed the nine-year-old was actually three grade levels behind.

[03:50:22] Good grades can be deceiving. Maya Martin Cadogan is the founder and executive director of Parents Amplifying Voices in Education. What we actually know is that many kids are not on grade level and that grades are oftentimes reflecting things that are not just about academics but reflecting behavior attendance participation in fact there's a dramatic disconnect with parents with looking at their own kids on how much academic learning has suffered since the end of the pandemic nationally nine out of ten parents regardless of race income or geography believe their child is

[03:50:59] at or above grade level but just 26 percent of eighth graders are proficient in math and only 29 percent are proficient in reading parents were just doing their best to make sure that kids were able to access school as it was but that doesn't mean it was what it should be and that will will them a hair table so what should parents do parents need to first just ask questions of their child's teacher they need to ask

what grade level their children were reading on what level math their children were doing and then ask what you can do at home with your child in order to support them and what additional programs they might need access to to extend their learning through summer

[03:51:39] programs i would say to parents to not be afraid to ask for help having that shared power between me and a teacher is a wonderful feeling jones is now working with christiana's teacher to understand where she needs help and she's seeking learning opportunities outside of school for this summer a good mixture of both summer camp and summer education at the same time i love solutions parents understand that the school day is not just eight to four it's 24 7 all the time seven days a week because that's really when kids are learning and applying the learning that they have in the

[03:52:15] classroom to the real world there have never been more resources available than right now to help kids get back on track i wish i knew sooner about christiana's education then i would been able to do other things to help. I'm glad that I'm finding out now because it's still time to be able to fix everything. There's no sign of good spending. Oh, I didn't see that.

[03:52:44] To learn more about how we can help your child this summer, check out gobeyondgrades.org. So that is just one video, one, you know, Charita's story. I could watch it again and again.

[03:53:06] Charita's a phenomenal mom, as most moms are. And so she went and got hooked on phonics for Christiana initially because she wasn't sure, you know, how to help her at home. And that's how she learned how to read. So she went on to Amazon and got hooked on phonics.

[03:53:24] And Christiana is on this amazing path. And so we lift up these stories of families all across the country. And families see themselves in these stories and know that they're not alone, that this often is in their gut. But when they see another mom sharing what they did and that there is a way to partner up with your teacher, it's really powerful.

[03:53:48] So we're continuing to get interest in these go beyond grades campaigns and are excited by the results that we're receiving. So now we can, now that you've seen sort of the big national picture, I think we're going to go into some of the work that's happening in Virginia. And I'm going to turn it over, Cindy.

[03:54:08] Thank you. I'll also say Commissioner Morath in Texas asked us to do a series of focus groups across the state around tutoring, why parents weren't taking them up on the tutoring that was being offered as a part of their bill, HB 4545. And almost universally what the parents said to us is we are so glad that tutoring is happening for all those kids that need it, but my kid doesn't need it.

[03:54:32] And so we couldn't find a parent that actually thought their child needed the tutoring. And so it just goes to show we can create all of the things to support parents, whether it's the tutoring or the after-school programming or the extended day.

[03:54:48] But until parents know it's their kid that needs it, the take-up rate is just not going to be there. And so with that in mind, Dr. Koons asked us to go listen to Virginia parents. So we went and listened to Virginia parents, and then we went and did in-depth interviews with principals, and in both situations, we were really focused on the SOL student score report and worked with Dr. Koons and her team to figure out sort of a protocol for these conversations to really go deep and figure out how, what is the value proposition of the SOL to the parent and to the principal.

[03:55:23] And so there are a lot of things we've learned, and we had a million quotes, but we brought you just a couple. But I just wanted to bring four opportunities to your attention in both of these sets of research for you to just sort of have in the back of your mind. One is something I can't remember our acronym from earlier today, the HW3, blah, blah, blah.

[03:55:43] So I'm going to give you another one, which is the SDBQ. It is so hard to say. As a matter of fact, I can't say it unless I'm staring at it. But the student detail by question. So you guys pay for Pearson to give you by student the questions that the student didn't get right, which is the thing the parent most wants to see on planet Earth.

[03:56:07] So we were working with the state of Texas on a long and learn more campaign where we had 2 million parents on the portal. One of the funnest things Bibb and I ever did because we were able to create a state portal there, which I know is not something you guys are able to do with all of the local control that's in place. But we got 2 million parents on the portal and where they spent all of their time, sometimes up to seven minutes, was looking at the questions their kids got wrong.

[03:56:35] And it had two really profound impacts. One was, oh my gosh, I now know how to help my kid because I've seen the question they couldn't get right. And I can take that question to my teacher and I can have a plan, which is the second thing they want most in the world. But the other thing was they no longer didn't like the test. They looked at the questions their kids didn't get right and said, I actually want my kids to know how to answer those questions. And there's so much cynicism in the system right now against all public institutions that they just assume it's all in a black box and it's all being done to them. And I think what is so amazing about what you guys are doing is the

[03:57:12] transparency thing is just huge. I mean, y'all are opening it all up. I mean, when I look at the work that Dr. Koons and her teams have done to like really define words like growth and proficiency where you have to use them and then take all the complex words out of everything where you don't. I think that, you know, you guys are doing everything you can, but the student detail by question, if there's a way to remarket that is like, here's the stuff your kid didn't get right.

[03:57:39] And to make it front and center on the score report, you already done so much to make that school report much more user-friendly for parents but I do think there are some additional things that could be done and just take credit for the fact that you have this because it demystifies the test. You know this but just in case you need another data point telling you parents want it sooner and what what actually just angers them is they don't get it in time to talk to the teacher that they've had all year long. So if they were fortunate enough to build a relationship with the teacher. They don't get to ask that same person what they can do over the summer to enroll in

[03:58:15] summer school, or they don't have the continuity to the next year. And so to the extent that I know you guys have such strong relationships with your division leads, but if there's a way to make something that's more of a gut check and not a plus or minus three with your psychometrician available more quickly, it's a great way to have a win with parents. Parents really want to talk to their teacher when they see the gaps in the SOLs. So, the ones that take the time just to really look at it, the number one thing they want to do is go talk to the teacher about what they've seen. So, again, that just argues for having it happen in the same school year with the teacher

[03:58:52] that they know and in the year in which the kid was supposed to learn the thing that's on the test. So, it makes common sense. I know you guys have spent a lot of time talking about it. This just

reinforces it with one more data point. And then we saw, as we see in actually every state, that so much work still needs to be done to help parents understand the value proposition of the SOL.

[03:59:12] So again, for us, the value proposition is that they get another data point that double checks the grade, right? When those two things are inconsistent, it gives you something to really go ask. Where it's most effective is when you can put those things in combination in a dashboard.

[03:59:30] So if somebody can see their SOL next to their grades, next to a map or a dibble or a lexile, we call that pay dirt. Like multiple measures in combination that don't make sense are the greatest way ever for parents to really know that they don't have an accurate picture. So to the extent that you can do that, right now everything is given to a parent in isolation in a different time frame, right? So you get your grades and in the middle of the summer you get your SOLs and then you might get a MAP diagnostic at the beginning of the year. And that's asking a lot for a parent to take those individual pieces and put them side by side. But to the extent that we

[04:00:09] as a system can start to bring them together right now, and we do a lot of work in Texas, but I will say in Texas, what they are doing is they've figured out how to put their store report on the portal where parents check homework. And that's actually super cool. It basically brings together like the power schools and all the different vendors and says, how do we put these two data points together so that parents are constantly being reminded, y'all are doing so much work to make the SOL really actionable for parents, but you also don't have control over how

[04:00:44] and when they see it. It feels like it's very much division by division around some of the timing and the predictability of it. So there might be some ways that you can create some predictability that don't feel like an overstep. If there are no questions there, I'll move to the second group, which is principals. We should have a contest for what to call the SDBQ. On principals, they asked for more support in analyzing school-wide trends. So that feels like data literacy, like help us

[04:01:17] just better understand all of the stuff that's coming our way. So they also, what we really heard is how much they respect what you think. And they really want to know what the State Department of education thinks they are looking for more guidance you definitely have their trust those relationships that you've built at the division level and then on down feel really solid the level and the timing of the disaggregated data for principals varied widely so they knew others that got it much earlier and others that got it much later so they were looking for some predictability

[04:01:53] around that and obviously nobody wants to be last so whoever got it soonest that's when they want to get it. But I think establishing some norms around that is something that principals would feel was very supportive for them and their work. They brought up that they have no way to train teachers on how to have conversations about data with parents. So they're looking for that PD. And what Bibb would say in the work that she's led with the training across the countries is principals need it too. So they may not have self-realized that in our conversations with us, but you need the principal to have the teachers back. So even though the teacher is the one that has to sit

[04:02:31] down with the parent, the principal really also needs to know and understand, just like he or she is an instructional coach, how do they also support that conversation? But one of our favorite quotes is, you know, there's nothing they've seen yet, like a toolbox or a toolkit of resources to provide parents. We have a lot of stuff that's fun around learning and unlearning. And then they're looking for help explaining the value proposition of the SOLs. I would say y'all have come a long way on that one in the last two years,

and there are probably a lot of resources that are already available that they just haven't seen yet. You have so many one-pagers, you have so many sets

[04:03:07] of definitions, there's so many things out there, and I think maybe just working more closely with the division leaders to make sure that they're, as one of my friends says, the water's getting to the end of the row. So that is, that's sort of, we had a ton of things that we learned, but those were sort of the four sort of that felt consistent across anything else on those i do think that that's something we can learn from though truly because um you know we went from a time where there really wasn't anything available right like it was a look you guys go you do your own thing

[04:03:42] you're your own school division you figure it out and we're in a time now where we're almost over i mean and i think the pandemic sort of shifted us into a we've got to overload with information because it or over communicate as far as you know what we're doing um from the state level from the department from the board um and and we have to really be intentional about how we are highlighting the information that's really important around specific things and so despite the fact that we do have all of these resources which i think are wonderful

[04:04:21] and certainly fitting if people are out there looking for them or if people are going to use them. And so driving the attention to those specific pieces, maybe there's something that we want to do. I know in your newsletter that you send out a spotlight. Did you know we have this resource on the DOE website that can help you do X, Y, or Z? That might be one of, we want to do like a spotlight type thing from time to time, just so that we make sure we're making people

[04:04:55] aware of the resources that are available. I also think we've got such inroads with VA ESP and VASSP. Those are elementary school and our secondary school principals. I think this is really good feedback for us to find ways to do more lunch and learns, more opportunities for our principals to have data literacy and how to have these conversations. So really appreciate the feedback absolutely and parents trust information they see on their school website the most so you guys have really modeled how to effectively communicate some of this really complex

[04:05:30] work but i do think you know how do you get it from the division leader to the school website because they're not coming straight to the state website they're coming here by default they're coming here because they can't get it anywhere else and so to the extent that we can some in some every state does it differently in new hampshire we got on the phone with every soup in new hampshire like and just sold them on the data like we've done a lot of different marketing techniques with different um state structures but to the extent that that literally they see you as modeling best practice on how to do it but then they pick it up and put it down in the place that parents actually are because most parents are too scared to go to a state of education website

[04:06:09] and when they do they don't know how to get their user id so i mean it's a long process to get the information from where you are to where they are but it's it's worth spending some time probably on the distribution i also think that we can't forget that so many of our principals so many of our building level leaders have been our teachers in the classroom yeah you know and if they didn't learn in that capacity how to use data to drive their instruction to interpret for parents on how to help their students then it only i mean it's it's only logical right that the principal who was

[04:06:48] the teacher you know doesn't know how to do that so i think that that is something certainly that we we can work on and video with some of these new big things you're putting out i mean the

resource hub is fantastic i mean i even saw there's a parent version of the readiness roadmap so but but we've asked principals in other locations you know do a three minute on this for your for your student population and for your parents and forcing them to do those sorts of things forces them to get conversant so there's some tricks around some of that that could be helpful but the base the baseline of information is there um so excited about the new performance framework

[04:07:27] can only imagine how much work that has been but really you have done a great job of avoiding words that are that we we spend countless hours trying to avoid shame and blame like that's never our intention for anything we do. We try to be as straightforward as possible. One of the words that has originated from our listening sessions for years has been on track. Parents literally say, I just want to know if my kid's on track. I just want to know if they're meeting expectations. That's all I want to know. And so, you know, on track here feels really strong and solid based on the

[04:08:00] research that we've done over the years. And I just think you all have done a fantastic job with these performance categories. They need to know why you've decided to tier these schools. And so being super overt and over communicating that the schools that are in this needs intensive support category or off track are getting something for it. Like the reason they don't assume they think that's why you did it because they don't. So the prevailing assumption of parents in the United States is that the schools that do the worst get the least amount of money. That is the working

[04:08:34] assumption and so it takes a lot of work for them to know that the opposite of that is true takes a very intentional communications effort and then you've already done this but really over explaining the clear weights for mastery growth and readiness even if they don't completely understand it what they appreciate is the transparency it's the same way with resources you might provide 10 resources they might not use any of them but it totally changes whatever they're looking at from a document that feels like a setup to a document that feels like a resource right so if they don't see any way that they can help then when they look at that document they

[04:09:12] think this was just done to me when there's something they can do then they actually really think the document's helpful so the concrete details even if they don't understand them all the tonality around that of respect and of transparency is just um is totally worth it and feel like you guys are doing that. Bridging the gap, you know, this particular effort I know was focused on learning loss. The piece that we wanted to bring to your attention was just this comprehensive training to teachers on how to communicate with parents and students. That's an area where we would love to partner. I'd love for Bibb to share more about what we're doing

[04:09:48] across the country on that, but that's where I feel like you've already identified it as a need and being a leader on that would would take you a long way um and then this idea of academic growth over time y'all worked really hard to define growth i know that the viva system is coming out as soon as february we'd love to help you have the charts and graphs on that viva system not look like this thing we screenshotted up there so i think making that work family friendly is is going to be hard but what we know is parents want to see a trajectory that line going up or that

[04:10:25] line going down is hugely important to them so the idea that they would get growth they would get on track they would get right direction they would get sort of this very simple way in which to understand how their kid is doing is is amazing um and uh and unprecedented i think in the amount of information you're going to give a parent but providing some context around that before the parent

actually sees it. So the other piece of advice we would just give from work we've done across the country, and Dr. Kuhn saw us do this in Tennessee, before you're telling something to a

[04:10:59] parent that's hard, they need to understand it. So whether that's like changing the cut scores or that's adopting Common Core, which happens to be two levels above where you are, or whatever that is, they can receive the information and understand it before it has their child's name on it. So those windows before you actually tell the parent are hugely opportunistic because they can hear it until they know it's their kid and then it gets harder because you're defensive and that's just human nature. So whatever can be done in front of these big giant changes that you're making to

[04:11:36] socialize the changes in advance, we would just love to support you in the doing of that. I'm going to pass it over to Bibb to talk about the parent-teacher planning tool, maybe some of the training? So we've talked a lot about parents and how we can support parents in advocating for their children. But there's also the teacher side and how do we support teachers in this very, very challenging work. And so one of our many tools, we create a lot of tools for teachers

[04:12:11] to be able to engage with families in affirming ways. And so we have a parent-teacher planning tool which you know granted is not the best fancy name but it is what it is and we have versions for parents and we have versions for teachers so that they can come together and understand unpack the data in really simple ways and then put together a learning plan so it has been we created it from the ground up with teachers and with parents and based on behavioral science so there's a lot of

[04:12:47] science and research that goes into this very simple three-step parent-teacher planning tool so we have some for the beginning of the year we have a version for the end of the year and it is just a language roadmap to help again facilitate that relationship in a non-heated way that just helps parents and teachers come together around the the learning needs of their child so you know virginia has taken um taken it and sort of customized it and tailored it for virginia parents and virginia teachers and it's being used all across the country in lots of different

[04:13:24] settings and we found it to be really effective as just a way to sort of bridge that home and school environment and it can happen online it can happen in person there are lots of different mechanisms to to be able to have this conversation that we think is really important this is just uh showing you all the great stuff we've had the privilege of doing with you and this is just the beginning but uh just wanting you to see that learning heroes and uh dr coons

[04:14:01] and her staff and have been we've all been working very closely together to try to simplify to take all the jargon out to meet parents where they are with the information they can use and so these These were just some visuals to show you that this work is very much in progress, but you guys keep making such big and huge decisions that there's clearly a lot of work still to do.

[04:14:22] And then we wanted to just open it up for an interactive conversation around other things. You see here some of the things that we've been working on, but would love to hear more from you guys on what you feel like would be advantageous.

[04:14:38] have mounds of research everything from kids with special needs to after school programs like you name it there's so much we could have talked about today so it'd be great just to know what other things might be helpful and pip why don't you come up and join me particularly if you have research

questions questions anyone mr hansen thank you very much for this this is very helpful i remember going back to some time at the department of education 30 years ago and we called a lot of

[04:15:18] of this the like woe be gone effect that um so this is obviously been around for a long time but um i just kind of keep coming back and i really appreciate this last piece about parents i um you know i've got six grown children now but back in the 90s and early 2000s um you know we talked a lot and about sols it was a cultural priority in our system at the time and um and so i i may be

[04:15:51] not as engaged because now it's with grandchildren versus children but i feel like for you know many families though that the communication with their teacher and with the school there just still is a barrier that is cultural it's and i just am wondering if there's some things that you've learned and your data and your research that are you know real life ways that can tear those barriers down. And I do view that some of the, it's just cultural. I feel like the teachers

[04:16:29] are so busy just teaching their children every day, diagnosing what's going on, and then to add that level of complexity on communicating with the parents. You know, I just sometimes like to compare this to the medical field, that when you, you know, get a biopsy, you're going to get those results back in three or four days, and you want the doctor or his assistant or her assistant to call you and let you know so that you can obviously start whatever interventions you may or may not need with that. And I just, and I've worked, I was a CEO of a company called

[04:17:04] Scantron, and we tried to come up, this was 15 years ago, with these reporting tools that would be almost instantaneous for parents to be able to go on and see, you know, an instant portal and kind of a report card, if you will, but very real and transparent. And I just feel like we've had a, you know, a thousand companies investing billions of dollars in this type of thing, and to really get it to a point where parents can have real-time data, real-time to understand, so they're not waiting, you know, for each quarter, or even worse, each year to understand the interventions that

[04:17:41] their students might need, but I just feel like there's still just such an innate system barrier for communication with parents, and especially those that need it the most, and I just, I'm sure you see this all around the country but just any thoughts on you know how we can really make some real progress and really opening up the communication lines in real time to really help those parents understand what their children are needing yeah thank you so much for that

[04:18:17] question there are a lot of ways to address these these barriers that have sidelined parents outside of the school building. And I think it starts with pre-service. Right now, teachers in training have no, there's no curriculum on how to engage with families at all. There are groups out there that we're partnering with that are working on that. We've talked with the, you know, UVA and Department of the Education College. We've talked with University of Michigan. We've talked with many esteemed colleges of education all across the country, and it just does not exist.

[04:18:57] So I think we need to start there because it is relationship building. I mean, we are humans and we cannot AI our way out of this. There are technology tools that are super helpful. So there is Remind and there is talking points and there are lots of tools, PowerSchool, Canvas,

[04:19:16] And they're incredibly helpful, but there's no replacing that relationship. And we see, and we're doing a study right now in partnership with TNTP to understand the role of strong family engagement,

what are the outcomes, and not just for achievement, but for the holistic school attendance, achievement, teacher retention, satisfaction.

[04:19:44] So as we think about retaining teachers, as we think about stabilizing enrollment in our public schools, I think it, you know, relationships really matter. So when Cindy did, you know, the, I think it was the slide before the Dear Virginia Parents letter, you know, we have a Dear Teacher letter that is like Mad Libs for those of us who remember Mad Libs, right?

[04:20:07] So it's here's what my child loves, here's what my child doesn't like, here's where they struggle, here's where my family comes from, this is who we are culturally, so that that teacher has a sense at the beginning of the year who that family is, the assets that they bring in.

[04:20:24] We have a similar letter for teachers to send home to parents. Here's who I am. Here's what I prioritize. There are home visits. There are lots of strategies that can be put into place. Again, school leaders play a role. It's really hard to have a good school without a good school leader.

[04:20:44] They have to have the vision to see that families, engaging families, is an instructional strategy. How do you want to improve your outcomes? Think about families as part of your instructional strategy. These are not carnivals, science nights. Those are lovely, important, but not sufficient.

[04:21:04] And so there are policies, practices, budgeting that has to be put into place, again, to give the teachers the time, the tools, the training to be able to do it. I mean, one anecdote, there's Brandon Pinckney he's a Baltimore city principal every Friday he sits with his teachers and and says okay tell me what your families need there it's a full expectation that once a week they go through and he knows what every family needs in that school and then they work to address

[04:21:38] those needs and his his outcomes and his scores in Baltimore City are the evidence like this community um is is thriving in in a setting that's really challenging so i think there are ways to do it um if we if you prioritize it and bring that intentionality around it miss holton thank you this is really oh thank you we really appreciate your terrific presentation if you can go back to

[04:22:09] the slide with the key findings and opportunities for parents yeah and i don't know how frankly how much of this question is to you and how much dr coombs may be able to help fill in but i'll ask it to you first so this the student detail by question and particularly parents need the sol score sooner and need to be able to talk to the what the third category kind of goes with the sooner need to be able to talk to the teachers to understand what to do that's just seems like it's been a perennial problem here in virginia across administrations um so my question to you is who what states are

[04:22:49] doing this well and what are they what are we missing that they're doing how come we haven't been able to get this right below these many i mean i will say this administration identified this as an issue when this administration started three years ago and yet i'm not maybe maybe we're doing things that i'm not yet aware of but what do we need to do to get there who what models can we look to how do we get how do we can i jump on real quickly before you finish that question because i think it's always been an issue of like as you all discussed it parents can go in and see the question and how their child answered it wrongly, correct? And I think it's always been

[04:23:25] an issue of test bank questions. Has it not? Well, I don't, I mean, I just want to hear, even if it's test bank, what are other states doing that we're not? Whatever the problem is, who's getting it right and how can we understand what we're doing compared to what they're doing?

[04:23:44] I'm just going to compare Tennessee to Virginia. Tennessee had an immediate, once you take the test, you're done. So it was much easier. But if you're in retake mode and you have an opportunity to retake, an opportunity to retake, we don't get some of those scores till July because of the retake window. So there is some challenges based on just the testing window and capacity that we have in statute here that is a difference from Tennessee. But don't we get the, I mean, you don't take, you don't do a retake unless you failed. So the school knows who failed because that's who they're offering a retake. You can't close the testing window to run the score reports.

[04:24:23] Yeah, but I mean, they have to close the window at least at the school level because they don't know who to offer the retake to until they have some data on who passed the first round. So in other words, the retake would be a great opportunity. We're identifying students who need to be offered an opportunity to retake. How do we engage with parents there? So retake is really unique to you guys. I mean, I appreciate Dr. Coons raising that because we did hear that from the principals that it makes the whole process messy with respect to the timing and how many students need it and how many don't. And then you've got parents who know and parents

[04:24:59] that don't know. And it also sounds like, and Dr. Koons will correct me if I'm wrong on this, but it also depends on the division that you're in. So, you know, I look a little bit to like Smarter Balanced, right, where they have like 13 states that they work with. And so they have a lot of variety across it. You can get that data right away. I mean, the state always wants to sit on it and quote clean it but this the the real-time impact is the school gets it at the same time and then the schools are able to share that with their teachers immediately so i think a conversation maybe with with the smarter balance team just around learnings around that because they have

[04:25:35] a 13-state consortium we've seen them sort of figure this out and i sat with my teacher and my principal in washington state immediately after the test because they were able to pull it up. So again, there are not necessarily perfect protocols around it. I think a lot of states are struggling with this. I mean, everybody's trying to get it out the door before the end of the school year. And usually it's not the school that slows that process down. It's at the administration level where they want to double check a couple of things and they're worried about being perfect

[04:26:11] as opposed to being good enough. President Creasy's point about the test bank has always been a perennial issue here in virginia and one of the problems there i think is that we do do our own tests you know virginia we're unique um we always like to think of ourselves as unique so we're not part of a consortium like smarter balance etc so we got to create our own test bank and we got to fund our own test bank and we don't um so i don't know how we i mean seems to me that those suggestions up here from parents are crucial and really should be our one of our very

[04:26:45] top priorities, but given that we're not in a consortium, given that we have test bank issues, et cetera, we haven't found a way to address it. The only other thing I'll say is when we've talked to parents about this as a part of a project we did for Smarter Balanced actually years ago, parents didn't care if they saw the actual question. They just wanted to see a question like the question their child didn't get right. They're just trying to figure out, is it adding and subtracting fractions? Like, what is it? So to the extent that you can use the same proxy questions every year parents are not parents are not looking for like this is the

[04:27:23] one but the what is it that they don't know so there may be some workarounds there that i think smarter balanced and others have used to not actually release items but to have a set of proxies for

each question and use them literally every year thank you um thank you for this presentation and for this work this is um you know as somebody whose kids were in school during the pandemic, if there's one silver lining, it was that I think a lot of parents' eyes were opened to maybe what they didn't know, you know, like what they didn't know about how their kids were

[04:28:02] doing. I think that there, as Bill mentioned, some, you know, real hurdles here, one of which is that during the pandemic, we kind of became complacent about this. So I was told, you know, yes, your child is behind, but everybody's behind. And so your child's on grade level now, basically. And I think we need to come back from that. And we need to really say, like, no, it's not enough to just compare to other kids who also suffered learning loss during the pandemic. But, you know, this is where your child ought to be. And that is tough to say to parents.

[04:28:40] And as a parent, it's tough to hear it. Another barrier that I see is, and you mentioned this, the, just, you know, people don't love the SOL. And I get it. Like no teacher wants to teach to a test. No parent wants their child taught to a test. And so I think there's an issue of messaging there that we need to get right and tell people like, no, we don't, you know, this doesn't paint the whole picture of your child, but this is a tool we use along with grades to see how they're doing. So I think we need to get that messaging right. And I appreciate what you're doing here to

[04:29:13] that end. You mentioned that Texas has on like the parent portal, all of this information. And here, I don't really see parents using anything like that until middle school. You know, there are people, correct me if I'm wrong, but I know like parents start using Schoology a lot in middle school to track their kids' homework assignments. And so I wonder how we could relay information to parents before middle school um like on some sort of dashboard i just don't know that parents use anything like that for that point and um also from like k through third seems to be kind of no man's

[04:29:52] land for like how parents see there aren't sols um and there's there is so much variation and like when a child will learn to read and so teachers are constantly reassuring parents like it's okay that your child doesn't know how to read yet. A lot of kids don't. But it just seems like K through third is where we most need to catch kids who aren't learning to read, because if they're not reading proficiently by fourth grade, they're on a pretty bad trajectory. And so I wonder if you found in other states a good way to catch kids in that window and relay it to parents.

[04:30:31] So you made me think of something that I should have actually also shared with member Hansen. actually arkansas is struggling with this right now they're rolling out uh a literacy screener for the first time ever and again you know the the time to talk about a new literacy screener that could say some things you don't want to hear is before your child gets their scores so they're they're in the process of really struggling with this i think the states that are learning in real time are the ones that are putting these literacy screeners in place because we really haven't communicated um and and dr coons may know more about this because tennessee has done some great

[04:31:04] work here. But that's the learning community right now is people who are putting the screeners out and giving parents an assessment score before third grade. And it is like totally green space. We know that parents are more hopeful the earlier you can get them. And an early education parent shows up dramatically different than a high school parent who's sometimes given up or feels like they're doing their job if they do disengage. So the earlier you can get them and a parent teacher relationship as a norm it is i mean you know we call it low-hanging fruit but like it it

[04:31:40] is the best way to go after it but i think we can look into some of the literacy screener work that's been done we're doing some of it but it's real time so we don't know yet like sort of how how it's going to land but dr coons you did some of this in tennessee yeah our number one way to get to parents was facebook and then having facebook retweeted for our k-3s we did free books for families during covid free pbs lessons we pushed everything out for early early grade parents through facebook and it was crazy we sold out of free literacy books and screeners and things

[04:32:16] in three days on facebook so facebook was the fastest way to communicate because then a school could just like and reshare and repost and repost so not that that's necessarily the direction we want to go, but that was the most effective way post-pandemic in Tennessee. And there's just one other example on the advocacy side. So I mentioned the Go Beyond Grades campaign. So the city of St.

[04:32:43] Louis, an advocacy organization within the, it's called Opportunity Trust. There is a state law in Missouri where every parent needs, is like legally obligated to know if their child is reading at a third grade level by third grade, but nobody knows about it. So they used the Go Beyond Grades campaign as a marketing tool to make sure parents knew that this law was in place and gave them the language to be able to ask their teachers. And then we also, again, created teacher materials for how to have these conversations with parents, because we know it is difficult.

[04:33:18] So we did the sort of the both and, but that's just another example of an organization that was like, oh, hey, this is an important thing for parents to know that this is actually something they should, they're like legally entitled to know. Ms. Holton? So the literacy screener, that's a great idea because I think I'm right. And Dr. Koons can help me remember the specifics, but I think we now require the literacy screener three times a year throughout the early grades.

[04:33:50] And that gives the teacher knowledge early on, beginning of the school year, middle of the year and end of the school year on where their child is but i don't remember dr kunst is there a parent yes so the parent must get that literacy so a parent really is getting something from the school fall and middle year as a former mimi when my grandson was in second grade last year in virginia we got it three times and i sat down with my daughter and we walked through it yes so and is that true was that in your school division or is that a statewide requirement

[04:34:25] a statewide requirement now with VALS. So all school parents are getting an opportunity to know where their child is on literacy, and that presumably tells them whether they're on grade level or not, fall, January, and spring in all the early grades. Yes. Presumably, however, the school has to push that out. Who has to push it out? School. So do we require them to push it out, or is that optional? It's probably in parent-teacher conferences, right?

[04:34:57] It's required to be pushed out. There's no monitoring. Well, maybe monitoring it is something we want to do. So I think it was one of the things that I highlighted a while ago, and I know we probably need to wrap up our discussion today for everyone, but I do think it's really, really critical. I mean, look, we can do all the screeners in the world. A teacher can see where a child is.

[04:35:24] We can send a piece of paper home to tell a parent where a child is, but if a parent doesn't understand what that report is saying about their child or how to help their child move to where they need to be, it's really useless.

[04:35:42] And so, you know, maybe this kind of gets to my question. How can you guys as learning heroes maybe help us with that? Yeah, we have seen it's really hard to translate complex data for teachers to families in ways that they can take action against them. So I really appreciate the question. We've been training teachers all across the country at different altitudes on ways to do this, both, you know, through video and through train the trainers.

[04:36:18] so lots of different so asynchronously statewide in California we have four modules that walk teachers through how to build relationships with families build that trust and then explain the data in context for that that family so they know what actions they can take it's on the tools for teachers platforms statewide free in California and then we've done other models again where we worked in Highline in Washington State, where we trained teacher trainers and worked with

[04:36:54] their assessment leads. So this is really important. To just work with the family engagement side of the division and not work in collaboration with the assessment teams, that's when the magic happens. Yes. So that's really important. And that's what we did in Highline. We've also been in several other districts in California, working deeply with a charter network in Minneapolis to do very customized deep teacher coaching. So each setting, there are tools that you can sort of

[04:37:28] universally give that help give teachers some basic understanding and context. But then we also do that deeper work at a district level to make sure whatever, wherever that district is, because districts are in different places. Schools are in different places. So we very much customize and tailor it to help support those teachers in having those conversations, unpacking the data.

[04:37:54] But first, they have to understand the data themselves, right? And then they can translate it. So that is the work that we do. Thank you. I would just add, we want to continue to come alongside Dr. Coons and her team. Like, the score report has come such a long way. You will not see the word vertical scale score. And that sounds common sense, but that was a battle, right? Like, and you guys won the battle because parents, when they see vertical scale score, what they say to us is they're intentionally trying to make sure I don't understand what I'm looking at. Like that cynicism against public institutions come in and they think you did it to them on purpose.

[04:38:31] But, you know, so part of this is just sharing that nobody in the system is actually trying to do that to parents on purpose so part of this too is just sharing what we know like we can come in as a third party with the research and say if you want to meet parents where they are with information they can use we have to talk about it like this if you want to confuse them and have them think that that's intentional you can hang on to these words you love but the margin of error cannot be bigger than the name of the student on the scoreboard right like and so psychometricians have um all the best intentions around the purity of their report but in the communicating of it you

[04:39:09] can lose a parent so we really try to say like have the information for parents be for parents by design not something that's tweaked that was for the administrator or the division leader or the state site and I feel like you guys are starting to really do that is create things for parents by design and have a different grain size against them and most states what we see the fatal flaw is they create one document and then when they need a parent document they just put the word parent on it can we just go a little deeper on that because that to me is I mean I'm

[04:39:44] I think doing more trainings for teachers would be great I think that's all like I'm all in on all of that but also I'm not ready to give up on the demand side so like extend your like which like what else

should we be doing in terms of engaging parents again this information out there to them We're coming up on another round of NAEP results here soon.

[04:40:05] Obviously, SOL results are an annual thing here. Like, critique us more. And as President Creasy sort of invited you all, like, what are things you could do? Like, we don't have an opportunity trust in Virginia. We don't have an organization like that.

[04:40:21] So, like, what are other things? You know, this is the equivalent of that organization here. So, what else could we be doing to engage and increase that demand side? I mean, you're already moving in this direction, but a one-stop shop for parents instead of a go-fetch is hugely important.

[04:40:38] So whether that's the parent resource hub or whatever that looks like, having a one-stop that's easy to navigate. You guys have so many things, but having them all in one place that then school districts and schools agree to put on the parents.

[04:40:55] Click here, red circle, for more information, right? You know, having, expecting them to go find what they need just doesn't happen in the course of their busy day. And then this is going to sound silly, but it's worth saying, making it mobile friendly. You know, most departments of ed just don't go that extra step of making sure it's mobile friendly and that it's easy to use on your phone. And so I think y'all have so many of the pieces and parts there, but creating, we've done a lot of what we call family portals.

[04:41:25] New Mexico is my favorite with the big balloons on it. You know, you can customize it for your state, but family portals allow parents to just click on four or five different things and have an FAQ. And then actually even better, and the thing I was going to mention to you, Member Hansen, is, you know, small video clips like Bibb was talking about that easily explain something in the voice of the principal or a teacher or one of you guys that says, here's the why we did this allows you to be you on you and not them on you. So, you know, here's why we change

[04:42:00] this. And having that quick two or three minute video that can go out on social can totally change a parent's perspective. So I would say really use digital media content where you've recruited leaders that are camera ready in their ability to communicate. There are probably a lot of things you could do that would help parents understand what you're doing better.

[04:42:27] One other suggestion. I mean, even if it's not a go beyond grades statewide campaign, storytelling is really compelling for families. So if there is a way to lift up different stories of Virginia families all across the states and teachers and model what that looks like, this is how you come together. I was struggling. I mean, if you look at Sherita, you know, she was very vulnerable in sharing her story about Christiana, it was hugely impactful.

[04:42:57] And again, we've done that in Tarrant County. We've done that in New York City. We could certainly do that in Virginia. But the power of storytelling to get that demand and give parents the sort of permission to go with their gut is another potential tool that you could deploy.

[04:43:14] Just very briefly, we're going to lose the space in five minutes. I can do it in 30 seconds. I just want to encourage you the you all great work and dr coons to not miss the opportunity to do this kind of work on our literacy screen because it gets to k through three and it gets to fall winter spring so tell us whether these parents are getting those reports and understanding them and help us help them understand thank you all so so so much we appreciate it thank you

[04:43:48] if you want. Okay. Thank you, everybody. I know we have to, we'll have to carry on tomorrow. So we will see you at nine o'clock tomorrow morning. And our work session is now adjourned.

